

38.	38	38	38. CONCERNING THE THE	38
The Superior	Intelligent control	True virtues are not	Those who possessed	The Tao■Master does
Superior power does	appears as uncontrol or	from this world,	perfectly the powers	not cling to power
not emphasize its	freedom. And for that	Therefore they are true	did not manifest them,	and is therefore truly
power,	reason it is genuinely	virtues	and so they preserved	powerful.
and thus is powerful.	intelligent control.	The so-called “virtues”	them. Those who	The lesser man clings
Inferior power never	Unintelligent control	in this world	possessed them	to power and thus has
forgets its power,	appears as external	Serve only self-interest	imperfectly feared	none.
and thus is powerless.	domination. And for	Therefore those are not	to lose them, and so	The truly powerful
Superior power never	that reason it is really	true virtues	lost them.	man does nothing [i.e.,
interferes nor has an	unintelligent control.	One who only serves	The	he practices non■ado
ulterior motive.	Intelligent control	the general interest, is	former did nothing, nor	(wu■wei)]
Inferior power	exerts influence	truthfully adequate	had need to do. The	and thus leaves nothing
interferes and has an	without appearing to	One who is called	latter did, and had	undone.
ulterior motive.	do so. Unintelligent	charitable in this	need to do.	The lesser man is
Superior humanity	control tries to	world,	Those	awhirl with activity
takes action but has no	influence by making a	Expects thankfulness	who possessed	and thus gets nothing
ulterior motive.	show of it.	in return	benevolence exercised	accomplished.
Superior morality takes	The generous giver	One who is called	it, and had need it; so	The virtuous man does
action and has an	gives because he wants	honest in this world,	also	what is good as an end
ulterior motive.	to give. The dutiful	Has a hidden agenda	was it with them who	in itself.
Superior custom takes	giver gives because he	Those who have been	possessed justice.	The moral man has a
action, and finding no	wants to receive.	adapted to this world	Those who possessed	need to do what is
response,	Whenever a regulation	Demand that others do	the conventions	good.
stretches out arms to	is imposed from above,	the same	displayed them; and	
force it on them.	it is not willingly		when men —	
	obeyed. Then effort is			
	used to enforce it.			
Therefore when the	—	Therefore, when	not agree, they made	and if people do not
Way is lost, power	—	people stray from the	ready to fight them.	follow him willingly,
arises.	—	straight and simple	Thus,	he forces them into
When power is lost,	—	road	when the Tao was lost,	line.
humanity arises.	—	Then they start to act	the Magick Powers	Thus, when the Tao is
When humanity is lost,	—	virtuously, but they are	appeared; then, by	lost, virtue arises.
morality arises.	—	not virtuous	successive	When virtue is lost,
When morality is lost,	—	They pretend to be	degradations, came	morality arises.
custom arises.	—	honest, but they are not	Benevolence, Justice,	When morality is lost,
Now custom is a	—	fair	Convention.	justice arises.
superficial expression	—	They act decently, but	Now	When justice is lost,
of loyalty and	—	they are not decent	convention is the	propriety arises.
faithfulness, and the	—	Civilization is just a	shadow of loyalty and	Propriety is merely a
beginning of disorder.	—	thin crust across	good will, and so the	shadow of justice,
Foreknowledge is the	—	unfaithfulness and	herald	morality, and virtue;
flowering of the Way	—	dishonesty	of disorder. Yea, even	it is the beginning of
and the beginning of	—	It is also the source of	Understanding is but a	chaos
folly.	—	disorder and chaos	Blossom of the Tao,	Therefore, the
Therefore the mature	—	A wise man never	and	Tao■Master stays with
dwell in the depth, not	—	hides behind a mask	foreshadoweth	the Tao.
in the thin,	—	He trusts what's inside	Stupidity.	He does not live on the
in the fruit and not in	—	of him, not in	So	surface of things.
the flowering.	—	appearances	then the Tao-Man	He looks to the fruit,
They reject one and	—	Therefore he rejects	holdeth to Mass, and	not to the flower.
accept the other.	—	appearance and	avoideth Motion; he is	
	—	embraces the essence	attached	

39.	39	39	39. THE LAW OF THE BEGINNING	39
Oneness	There are things that	About the men of old	These things have	In archaic times, by
The ancients attained	have always	that had reached	possessed the Tao from	attaining the One,
oneness.	maintained their own	perfection	the beginning: Heaven,	Heaven became clear;
Heaven attained	tendency to initiate is,	We know that they felt	clear and	Earth became stable;
oneness and became	by its self-activity,	one with the whole	shining; Earth, steady	spirit became
clear.	obviously	creation	and easy; Spirits,	transcendent;
Earth attained oneness	self-originating. The	That they saw the earth	mighty in Magick;	valleys became full;
and became stable.	tendency towards	not as chaos but as a	Vehicles, overflowing	the ten thousand things
Spirits attained oneness	completion is, by its	unity	with Joy; all that hath	became alive;
and became divine.	self-activity, always	That they felt like gods	life; and the rulers of	rulers made the
The valleys attained	self-perfection. The	and spiritual beings	men.	country ordered and
oneness and became	tendency to maintain	That emptiness was no	All these derive their	secure.
fertile.	integrity, by its	longer empty, but filled	essence from the Tao.	This implies that
Creatures attained	self-activity, sustains	And they saw that the	Without	If Heaven lacked
oneness and lived and	integrity. The tendency	whole creation was	the Tao, Heaven would	clarity, it would be
grew.	to oppose is, by its	inspired	dissolve Earth disrupt,	divided;
Kings and nobles	self-activity, sufficient	Thanks to their	Spirits become	If the Earth lacked
attained oneness and	for all opposition.	wholeness the world	impotent; Vehicles	stability, it would be
became leaders.	It is by self-activity	returned to its original	empty; living things	shaky;
What made them so is	that all things fulfill	order	would perish and rulers	If spirit lacked
oneness.	themselves. So it is by	For one who doesn't	lose	transcendence, it
Without clarity, heaven	self-activity that the	see clearly, the creation		would be used up;
would crack.	world is governed.	is splintered		If valleys lacked
Without stability, the	Such is the extent of			fullness, they would be
earth would quake.	self-activity.			depleted;
—	—	—	their power.	If the ten thousand
—	—	—	The	things lacked life, they
—	—	—	root of grandeur is	would fade away;
—	—	—	humility, and the	and if rulers lacked
—	—	—	strength of exaltation	nobility, they would
—	—	—	in its	fall,
—	—	—	base. Thus rulers speak	and the country would
—	—	—	of themselves as	be collapse into chaos.
—	—	—	'Fatherless,'	Therefore, the humble
—	—	—	'Virtueless,'	is be root of the noble;
—	—	—	'Unworthy,'	the lowly is the
—	—	—	proclaiming by this	foundation of the high;
—	—	—	that their Glory is in	rulers call themselves
—	—	—	their shame. So	"orphans," "widows,"
—	—	—	also the virtue of a	and "worthless."
—	—	—	Chariot is not any of	This is taking the
—	—	—	the parts of a Chariot,	humble and the lowly
—	—	—	if they be	as the root and
—	—	—	numbered. They do not	foundation,
—	—	—	seek to appear fine like	is it not?
—	—	—	jade, but inconspicuous	You can have all the
—	—	—	like	parts of a chariot
—	—	—	common stone.	without having a
—	—	—		chariot.
—	—	—		
—	—	—		

Chapter 40 Sanderson Beck	Chapter 40 Archie J. Bahm	Chapter 40 Anonymous	Chapter 40 Aleister Crowley	Chapter 40 George Cronk
40. Movement of the Way Returning is the movement of the Way. Gentleness is the method of the Way.	40 Nature alternates dynamically. When it completes what it is doing, then it starts all over again.	40 One who deviates from the right and simple road Will be pulled towards it again This occurs with a mild touch	40. OMITTING UTILITY The Tao proceeds by correlative curves, and its might is in weakness.	40 Reversal is the motion of the Tao. Yielding is the way of the Tao.
All things in the world come from being, and being comes from non-being.	All that is springs from such alternation.	The whole creation comes into existence The existing out of the unnameable unexisting	All things arose from the Teh, and the Teh budded from the Tao.	All things emerge from being. Being emerges from non-being.

41.	41	41	41. THE IDENTITY OF THE DIFFERENTIAL	41
What the Way is Like	When the intelligent	When the most sincere	The best students,	When a thoughtful
When the wise hear the	man hears about	hear about the road to	learning of the Tao, set	man hears of the Tao,
Way, they practice it	Nature's alternating	self-knowledge,	The best students,	he tries to follow it.
diligently.	ways, he seeks to	They will devote	learning of the Tao, set	When an average man
When the mediocre	embody it within	themselves to bringing	to work earnestly to	hears of the Tao,
hear of the Way, they	himself. The mediocre	it into practice	practice	he wonders about it,
doubt it.	man sometimes accepts	When the fairly sincere	the Way. Mediocre	but then tends to forget
When the foolish hear	it and sometimes does	hear about the road to	students now cherish it,	it.
of the Way, they laugh	not.	self-knowledge	now let it go.	When a fool hears of
out loud.	Unintelligent men	They will only get out	The worst students	the Tao, he makes fun
If it were not laughed	scoff at it. Yet this very	of it what suits their	mock at it. Were it not	of it.
at, it would not be the	scoffing at intelligence	purposes	thus mocked, it were	If someone didn't make
Way.	itself exemplifies	When the hardened	unworthy	fun of it, it wouldn't be
Therefore it is said,	Nature's way of	hear about the road to	to be Tao.	the Tao.
"The enlightenment of	alternation.	self-knowledge	Thus	Therefore, when
the Way seems like	This is the reason for	They will roar with	spake the makers of	seeking the Tao,
dullness;	the old sayings:	laughter	Saws: the Tao at its	light seems dark,
progression in the Way	Nature's brightest day	If they didn't roar, it	brightest is obscure.	advancing feels like
seem like regression;	fades into night.	would not be true	Who	retreating,
the even path of the	Nature's most luxuriant	Therefore there are		
Way seems to go up	growth ages toward	some aphorisms to it:		
and down."	decay. Nature's	The road to light		
	smoothest plain erodes	appears to be dark		
	itself away into rough			
	terrain.			
Great power appears	Nature's most	—	advanceth in that Way,	the simple appears
like a valley.	harmonious adjustment	—	retireth. Its smooth	difficult,
Great purity appears	generates conflict.	—	Way is rough. Its	power is like
tarnished.	Nature's most beautiful	—	summit is	weakness,
Great character appears	objects grow dim and	—	a valley. Its beauty is	purity seems tarnished,
insufficient.	ugly. Nature's greatest	—	ugliness. Its wealth is	true virtue seems
Solid character appears	prize soon becomes	—	poverty. Its virtue,	deficient and unsteady,
weak.	despised. Nature's	—	vice. Its stability is	and the clear seems
True integrity appears	strongest power	—	change. Its form is	obscure.
changeable.	eventually weakens.	—	without form. Its	The true square has no
Great space has no	Nature's soundest	—	fullness	corners.
corners.	supports gradually rot	—	is vacancy. Its	The true vessel never
Great ability takes time	away. Nature's squarest	—	utterance is silence. Its	sails.
to mature.	corners soon become	—	reality is illusion.	The true sound is hard
Great music has the	rounded. Nature's	—	Nameless	to hear.
subtlest sound.	grandest structures	—	and imperceptible is	The true form has no
Great form has no	sooner or later are	—	the Tao; but it	shape.
shape.	destroyed. Nature's	—	informeth and	The Tao is hidden,
The Way is hidden and	loudest sounds are	—	perfecteth	beyond definition; but
indescribable.	finally silenced.	—	all things.	it alone fulfills.
Yet the Way alone is	Hence, Nature,	—		
adept	although beyond	—		
at providing for all and	comprehension and	—		
bringing fulfillment.	description, Knows	—		
	how to bring about,	—		
	alternately, all	—		
	initiating and	—		
	completing.	—		

42. All Things The Way produced the One; the One produced two; two produced three; and three produced all things. All things have the receptivity of the female and the activity of the male. Through union with the life force they blend in harmony.	42 Nature first begets one thing. The one thing begets another. The two produce a third. In this way, all things are begotten. Why? Because all things are impregnated by two alternating tendencies, the tendency towards completion and the tendency towards initiation, which acting together, complement each other.	42 The unspeakable gives birth to one One to a second And out of the second arises the third The third brings the whole creation to life Everything is carried by the dark and comes to light The breath of Emptiness creates order People hate to be alone, unimportant and useless	42. THE VEILS OF THE TAO The Tao formulated the One. The One exhaled the Two. The Two were parents of the Three. The Three were parents of all things. All things pass from Obscurity to Manifestation, inspired harmoniously by the Breath of the Void.	42 Out of Tao, One. Out of One, Two. Out of Two, Three. Out of Three, all things. All things carry Yin and face Yang. Out of the union of Yin and Yang, harmony. No one wants to be "orphaned," "widowed," or "unworthy."
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People hate being orphaned, lonely, and unworthy. Yet kings and nobles call themselves such. Often gain can be a loss, and loss can be a gain. What others teach, I teach also: "The violent die a violent death." I shall make this primary in my teaching.	Most men dislike to be considered of no account, lowly, unworthy. Yet intelligent leaders call themselves thus. For people are admired for their humility and despised for their pride. There are many other ways of illustrating what I am teaching: "Extremists reach untimely ends." This saying may be taken as a good example.	And yet that is what a true man takes pleasure in One who becomes smaller, becomes bigger One who becomes bigger, becomes smaller I only tell what everybody already knows: One who lives in a complicated way, dies in a complicated way That is what it's all about	Men do not like to be fatherless, virtueless, unworthy: yet rulers describe themselves by these names. Thus increase bringeth decrease to some, and decrease bringeth increase to others. Others have taught thus; I consent to it. Violent men and strong die not by natural death. This fact is the foundation of my law.	But kings and princes use these words as titles for themselves. You win by losing. You lose by winning. It has been said, and I agree, "A violent man dies violently."
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43.
The Value of
Non-action
The softest things in
the world overcome
the hardest.
Non-being penetrates
even where there is no
space.

43
That which is most
yielding eventually
overcomes what is
most resistant. That
which is not becomes
that which is. Acting
without coercing or
being coerced is best.

43
The softest is stronger
than the very hardest
That which makes
everything be what it
is, penetrates
everything
Therefore I know that
it's wise to leave and
not do anything

43. THE COSMIC
METHOD
The softest substance
hunteth down the
hardest; the
unsubstantial

43
The softest thing
overcomes the hardest
thing.
That which has no
substance can enter
where there is no
space.

Through this I know
the value of
non-action.
Teaching without
words and the value of
non-action
are understood by few
in the world.

Guiding by example
rather than by words is
most successful. Such
simple truths are so
hard to understand.

That one doesn't need
lessons for it
That of all doings,
leaving is where true
happiness lies
In this world only a
few understand this

penetrateth where there
is no opening. Here is
the Virtue of Inertia.
Few
are they who attain:
whose speech is
Silence, whose Work is
Inertia.

This shows the value
of non-**■**ado.
Teaching without
words; doing without
ado: hard to
accomplish.

44. How to Endure Fame or your life, which do you love more? Life or material wealth, which is more valuable? Loss or gain, which is worse? Therefore those who desire most spend most.	44 Esteem by others or self-esteem, which is better? To value things or to value yourself, which is better? To have more or to have less, which is worse?	44 What comes first, life or status? What's more important to you, yourself or your possessions? What's worse, having or losing? One who wants a lot pays a high price	44. MONITORIAL What shall it profit a man if he gain fame or wealth, and lose his life? If a man cling to fame or wealth, he risketh what is worth more.	44 Fame or self: which matters more? Self or possessions: which is more valuable? Loss or gain: which is worse? Attachment to things brings suffering.
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Those who hoard most lose most. Those who are contented are not disappointed. Those who know when to stop prevent danger. Thus they can long endure.	The more you have, the more you have to lose. The more you value things, the less you value your self. The more you depend on others for esteem, the less you are self-sufficient. He who knows how to discriminate wisely avoids danger, And continues safely on his way.	One who has a lot, has a lot to lose But one who is satisfied knows neither fear nor disgrace And one who has stopped playing a part in the game will never be afraid again and will live happily ever after	Be content, not fearing disgrace. Act not, and risk not criticism. Thus live thou long, without alarm.	Much hoarded, much to be lost. Know when enough is enough. Avoid disgrace. Know when to stop. Avoid danger. This is how to endure.
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45.
Skill Seems Awkward
The greatest perfection
seems incomplete,
but its utility is never
impaired.
The greatest fullness
seems empty,
but its use cannot be
exhausted.

45
What is most complete
is still incomplete: Yet
it is as complete as it
can be. That which has
achieved the most, still
has the whole of its
future yet to be
achieved: Hence it will
not stop achieving.

45
Perfection seems
unfinished to this
world
But it never perishes
Fullness is empty to
the world
But it's inexhaustible
That which is correct,
is incorrect to the
world

45. THE
OVERFLOWING OF
THE
Despise thy
masterpieces; thus
renew the vigor of thy
creation.
Deem thy fullness
emptiness; thus shall
thy fullness never be
empty.

45
The perfect seems
flawed, but its
usefulness is unlimited.
Full seems empty, but
it is inexhaustible.
Straight seems bent.
Intelligent seems
stupid.

What is most direct
seems devious.
The greatest skill
seems awkward.
The greatest eloquence
seems like stuttering.
Movement overcomes
cold.
Stillness overcomes
heat.
The serene and calm
are guides for all.

Make a thing as
straight as possible;
Yet it is still crooked or
will become crooked.
Acquire the greatest
skill; And there will
still be endless skill to
be acquired. Develop
the greatest power of
expression; And there
will be much that is
unexpressed and
inexpressible.
The same may be said
about activity and
passivity and cold and
heat. Only he who
fully accepts these
alternations is the best
guide for all to follow.

Wisdom seems foolish
to the world
Telling the truth a
disgrace
Like movement chases
away coldness
And rest cools down
Purity and calmness
show one the right
direction

Let the straight appear
crooked to thee, thy
Craft clumsiness; thy
Musick
discord.
Exercise
moderately cold;
stillness heat. To be
pure and to keep
silence, is the True
Law of all that are
beneath Heaven.

Eloquent seems
tongue-tied.
Motion defeats the
cold.
Stillness defeats the
heat.
The Taoist Master
remains calm as a
guide for all things.

46. Contentment When the world lives in accord with the Way, horses work on farms. When the world does not live in accord with the Way, the cavalry practices in the parks.	46 When what is natural prevails in human affairs, horses forced to train for racing are returned to the fertile pastures. When artificiality prevails in human affairs, horses are trained for war and are restricted to walled enclosures.	46 If men lived by their nature Horses would gallop in the open air But since men got civilized Battle horses standing at the frontier There is no bigger curse than dissatisfaction	46. THE WITHDRAWAL FROM AMBITION When the Tao beareth away on Earth, men put swift horses to night-carts. When it is neglected, they breed chargers in the border marches.	46 When the kingdom is in harmony with the Tao, the horses haul manure. When the kingdom departs from the Tao, war■horses are bred in the land.
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The greatest temptation to crime is desire. The greatest curse is discontent. The greatest calamity is greed. Whoever is content with contentment is always content.	There is no greater evil than desiring to change others - (to take from or give to others what they do not, of their own accord, want to give or take). There is no greater misfortune than desiring to change oneself - being discontented with one's lot. There is no greater vice than desiring to change things - (to possess, control, or reconstruct their natures). Only he who is satisfied with whatever satisfactions his own nature provides for him is truly satisfied.	Nothing more disastrous than being discontent with life Nothing more fatal than being eager for possessions One who knows the peace of satisfaction, is always satisfied	There is no evil worse than ambition; no misery worse than discontent; no crime greater than greed. Content of mind is peace and satisfaction eternal.	There is no greater curse than wanting more than enough. There is no greater sin than greed. He who knows when enough is enough always has enough.
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47.
Understanding
One can know the
world without going
outside.
One can see the Way
of heaven
without looking out the
window.

47
Without going
out-of-doors, one can
know all he needs to
know. Without even
looking out of his
window, one can grasp
the nature of
everything. Without
going beyond his own
nature, one can achieve
ultimate wisdom.

47
Without leaving my
house, I understand the
whole world
Without looking
outside, I see the
perfect order

47. THE VISION OF
THE DISTANT
One need not pass his
threshold to
comprehend all that is
under Heaven,
nor to look out from
his lattice to behold the
Tao Celestial. Nay! but

47
You can know the
whole world without
going out the door,
You can know the Way
of Heaven without
looking out the
window.

The further one goes
the less one knows.
Therefore the wise
know without going
about,
understand without
seeing,
and accomplish
without acting.

Therefore the
intelligent man knows
all he needs to know
without going away,
And he sees all he
needs to see without
looking elsewhere,
And does all he needs
to do without undue
exertion.

The more you know,
the less you'll
understand
One who is wise
doesn't need to travel
He understands
without looking
Does nothing but
achieves everything

the farther a man
goeth, the less he
knoweth.
The
sages acquired their
knowledge without
travel; they named all
things
aright without
beholding them; and,
acting without aim,
fulfilled their
Wills.

The further afield you
go, the less you know.
The Taoist Master
knows without going
out;
understands without
looking;
achieves without ado.

48. Doing Less The pursuit of learning is to increase day by day. The practice of the Way is to decrease day by day. Less and less is done until one reaches non-action.	48 While day by day the overzealous student stores up facts for future use, He who has learned to trust nature finds need for ever fewer external directions.	48 Gathering knowledge makes life more complicated each time one gathers Gathering wisdom makes life easier each time one gathers Each time, more and more simple until simplicity is reached	48. OBLIVION OVERCOMING KNOWLEDGE The scholar seeketh daily increase of knowing; the sage of Tao daily decrease of doing. He decreaseth it, again and again, until he doth no act with the lust of	48 Pursue learning, gain daily. Follow the Tao, lose daily. By losing day■by■day, you arrive at non■ado.
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When nothing is done, nothing is left undone. The world is led by not interfering. Those who interfere cannot lead the world.	He will discard formula after formula, until he reaches the conclusion: Let Nature take its course. By letting each thing act in accordance with its own nature, everything that needs to be done gets done. The best way to manage anything is by making use of its own nature; For a thing cannot function properly when its own nature has been disrupted.	Just by leaving, one man can achieve everything One who wants nothing anymore, doesn't feel the need to do a thing, has conquered oneself One who wants a lot has to do a lot and is as a slave to oneself	result. Having attained this Inertia all accomplisheth itself. He who attracteth to himself all that is under Heaven doth so without effort. He who maketh effort is not able to attract it.	Nothing done, nothing left undone. Master the world by letting things be, by letting them take their own course. The world can't be conquered.
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49.
The Power of
Goodness
The wise have no
mind-set.
They regard the
people's minds as their
own.
They are good to
people who are good.
They are also good to
people who are not
good.
This is the power of
goodness.

49
The intelligent man is
not willful. He accepts
what others will for
themselves as his will
for them.
Those who appear as
good, he accepts, And
those who appear as
bad, he accepts; For
Nature accepts both.

49
A wise man has no
opinion at all
Therefore he can easily
put himself in someone
else's position
He accepts everybody
and everything for
what it is
In spite of any
behaviour
He trusts the honest
and the unfair
And naturally they
become fair-minded

49.THE
ADAPTABILITY OF
THE THE
The wise man hath no
fixed principle; he
adapteth his mind to
his
environment.
To
the good I am good,
and to the evil I am
good also; thus all
become

49
The Tao■Master does
not have his heart set
on anything in
particular.
He wants to understand
the hearts of the
people.
He is good to people
who are good.
He is also good to
people who aren't
good.
This is true goodness.

They are honest to
those who are honest.
They are also honest to
those who are
dishonest.
This is the power of
honesty.
The wise live in the
world peacefully and
harmoniously.
The people share a
common heart,
and the wise treat them
as their own children.

Those who appear
faithful, he accepts,
And those who appear
unfaithful, he accepts;
For Nature accepts
both.
The intelligent man
treats every kind of
nature impartially, And
will good to one as
much as the another.
All people admire the
intelligent man,
Because he regards
them all as a mother
regards her children.

He trusts the reliable
and the unreliable
And naturally all will
become reliable
A wise man feels one
with all people
They are all just as
precious to him
They look and listen to
him
And all are as children
to him

good. To the true I am
true, and to the false I
am true; thus all
become
true.
The
sage appeareth
hesitating to the world,
because his mind is
detached.
Therefore the people
look and listen to him,
as his children; and
thus
doth he shepherd them.

He trusts people who
are trustworthy.
He also trusts people
who aren't trustworthy.
This is true trust.
The Tao■Master
radiates peace and
harmony.
Through him, the
hearts of the people are
made one.
Are the people his
children, or is he their
child?

50.
Those Who Preserve
Life
Coming into life and
going out at death,
the organs of life are
thirteen;
the organs of death are
thirteen;
and these thirteen
make life vulnerable to
death.
Why is this so?
Because they feed life
too grossly.
It is said that those who
preserve life
walk the earth without
fearing tigers and wild
buffalo,

50
It is natural for man to
be born and to die. And
it is natural for each of
his parts to be born and
to die and to evolve
through its life cycle.
Why do men become
so perturbed and
anxious to prolong the
life of each part when
endangered? The truth
is that whatever is
natural is good.

50
Humans come and go
Their bodies as the seat
of life
Their bodies as the seat
of death
Humans get old and
decay
Why is that?
It's because they are
already dead, but think
that they're living
There have been
stories told and written
about people who had
found true life

50.
THE ESTIMATION
OF LIFE
Man cometh into life,
and returneth again
into death.
Three
men in ten conserve
life; three men in ten
pursue death.
Three
men also in ten desire
to live, but their acts
hasten their journey
to the house of death.
Why is this? Because
of their efforts to
preserve life.
But
this I have heard. He
that is wise in the
economy of his life,

50
Come into life, go into
death.
Three out of ten have a
lust for life.
Three out of ten have a
lust for death.
Three out of ten just
pass from birth to
death
without appreciating
either life or death.
Why is this?
Because none of them
appreciates both life
and death.
But there are those
[one out of ten?]

and in battle they are
not touched by
weapons of war.
The wild buffalo's
horns find nothing to
gore;
the tiger's claws find
nothing to tear;
and weapons' points
find nothing to pierce.
Why is this so?
Because they have
nothing for death to
enter.
(Note: The thirteen
organs of life may refer
to the nine openings
in the body and the
four limbs.)

Since it is natural for
man to dies anyway,
being assisted by horn
or claw or spear in
bringing about his
death in no way
endangers his nature.
No wild buffalo horn
can change the course
of Nature. No tiger's
claw can act
unnaturally. No
soldier's spear can go
against Nature. Why?
Because death is
natural, but Nature
cannot die.

And wandered around
the earth
Not afraid of tigers or
rhinos
Those who avoided
weapons and violence
And lived in harmony
with all creatures
Therefore no creature
felt threatened by them
And no weapon could
harm them
Why is that?
Because they were
only living
And that's where there
is no room for death

whereof he is warden
for a season,
journeyeth with no
need to avoid the
tiger or the rhinoceros,
and goeth uncorsleted
among the warriors
with no
fear of sword or lance.
The rhinoceros findeth
in him no place
vulnerable
to its horn, the tiger to
its claws, the weapon
to its point. Why is
this? Because there is
no house of death in
his whole body. {56}

who appreciate both
life and death.
When they travel the
country, they are not
attacked by rhinos and
tigers.
When they go into
battle, they are not
wounded.
The rhino finds
nothing to gore.
The tiger finds nothing
to claw.
Weapons find nothing
to pierce.
Why? Because such
people have gone
beyond death.

51. Mystical Power The Way produces all things. Power nourishes them. Matter gives them physical form. Environment shapes their abilities. Therefore all things respect the Way and honor power. The Way is respected, and power is honored without anyone's order and always naturally.	51 Nature produces things, and intelligence guides them. Although different in kind, each thing has its own self-sufficient intelligence to guide it. Nothing can fail to emulate Nature and intelligence by embodying them within its own life. Such emulation is not demanded, but occurs of its own accord.	51 The Unspeakable makes all things appear The active force determines their nature Their nature determines their shape The circumstance determines their final appearance Therefore all creatures, With the exception of erring mankind, honour the Unspeakable And live according to their natures This is all a natural process	51. THE TEH AS THE NURSE All things proceed from the Tao, and are sustained by its forth-flowing virtue. Every one taketh form according to his nature, and is perfect, each in his particular Way. Therefore, each and every one of them glorify the Tao, and worship its forth-flowing Virtue. This glorifying of the Tao, this worship of the Teh, is constantly spontaneous, and not by appointment of Law.	51 Tao gives birth to the ten thousand things. Te nurtures them. They are formed from matter and completed by environment. Therefore, the ten thousand things honor Tao and respect Te, not in response to commandments, but just naturally.
Therefore the Way produces all things, and power nourishes them, caring for them and developing them, sheltering them and comforting them, nurturing them and protecting them, producing them but not possessing them, helping them but not obligating them, guiding them but not controlling them. This is mystical power.	Nature originates and suckles, rears and develops, protects and provides for, and guides and perfects all things. Whatever is produced, Nature accepts it for what it is. However it behaves, Nature lets it follow its own way. Whatever its fortune, Nature injects no external interference. Such is Nature's marvelous sagacity.	And nobody rewards them for it The Unspeakable makes them live, feeds them, makes them grow Fulfils them, gives them peace, supports and guards them It makes them live, but never forces them It takes them along the stream of life, but does not possess It makes mature, but does not control That is an unfathomable mystery	Thus the Tao buddeth them out, nurtureth them, developeth them, sustaineth them, perfecteth them, ripeneth them, upholdeth them, and reabsorbeth them. It buddeth them forth, and claimeth not lordship over them; it is overseer of their changes, and boasteth not of his puissance; perfecteth them, and interfereth not with their Ways; this is called the Mystery of its Virtue.	Tao gives birth to the ten thousand things, and Te nurtures, rears, develops, shelters, and protects them. But Tao and Te do not try to own or rule the ten thousand things, nor do they seek to make them dependent. This is true power.

52. Practicing the Eternal The beginning of the universe is the mother of all things. Those who discover the mother understand the children. Understanding the children and returning to the mother, they live always free from harm. Close the mouth, shut the doors,	52 Nature, because it has mothered all, may be regarded as Mother Nature. He who understands Mother Nature, understands her children. But to avoid the children's mistakes, one should follow close to Mother Nature herself, If throughout his life he desires a safe guide.	52 The world sprouts from something People could call it the mother of the world When one knows that mother, one knows her child One who becomes like that child again, will know the mother And for the rest of his life nothing can harm him ever again He won't criticize anyone and lets no one influence him And his life will be without worries	52. THE WITHDRAWAL INTO THE SILENCE The Tao buddeth forth all things under Heaven; it is the Mother of all. Knowing the Mother, we may know her offspring. He that knoweth his Mother, and abideth in Her nature, remaineth in surety all his days. With the mouth closed, and the Gates of Breath controlled, he remaineth	52 The world's Source, the Mother of all things. Knowing the Mother, we know her children. Knowing the children, but holding on to the Mother, we are free from the fear of death.
and all of life is without strain. Open the mouth, meddle with affairs, and all of life is beyond help. Seeing the small is insight; to stay with the gentle is strength. Use the Light, return to insight, and thereby be preserved from harm. This is practicing the eternal.	If one remains silent and keeps to himself, he will not fail to fulfill his life; But is he gives advice and meddles in others' affairs, he invites trouble. If you see what is small as it sees itself, And accept what is weak for what strength it has, and use what is dim for the light it gives, Then all will go well. This is called acting naturally.	But one who condemns others and whose interests concern only himself Will be full of worries the rest of his life One that sees a gleam of light in darkness sees the light at the end of the tunnel Holding on to that gleam of light requires strength One who follows that light, turns back to the original light Then all danger is gone And you'll live the eternal life	at ease all his days. With the mouth open, and the Breath directed to outward affairs, he hath no surety all his days. To perceive that Minute Point is True Vision; to maintain the Soft and Gentle is True Strength. Employing harmoniously the Light Within so that it returneth to its Origin, one guardeth even one's body from evil, and keepeth Silence before all men.	Stop talking, withdraw from the rat ¹ race, and life is full. Blab on, lose yourself in busy ² ness, and life is lost. Seeing the small requires good vision. Yielding is strength. Turn to the Inner Light, and find the eternal.

53.
Leaders in Robbery
Those with even a
scrap of sense
walk on the main way
and fear only straying
from the path.
The main way is
smooth and easy,
but people like to be
side-tracked.
While the courts are
arrayed in splendor,

53
Let us be intelligent
and follow Nature
itself. Let us not stray.
Nature's way is simple
and easy, but men
prefer the intricate and
artificial.
When they congregate
in artistically
engineered cities, and
neglect their farms,
their food supply is cut
off.

53
When I possess True
Knowledge
I will stroll on the right
and simple road
I will avoid side paths
Because the straight
road is easy to walk
But most people love
the narrow side paths
The residences of the
rich are neat and clean
But the fields of the
poor are filled with
weeds

53. THE WITNESS
OF GREED
Were I discovered by
men, and charged with
government, my first
would be
lest I should become
proud.
The
true Path is level and
smooth; but men love
by-paths.
They
adorn their courts, but
they neglect their
fields, and leave their

53
If I had any sense, I
would walk on the
main road [the Tao],
and I would fear
leaving it.
Keeping to the main
road [the Tao] is so
easy,
and yet people love to
stray from it as they
seek shortcuts.
Look! The royal palace
is magnificent,

the fields are full of
weeds,
and the granaries are
empty.
Yet some wear
embroidered clothes,
carry sharp swords,
over-indulge
themselves with food
and drink,
and have more
possessions than they
can use.
They are leaders in
robbery.
This is not the Way.

When they bedeck
themselves with
ornaments and
weapons, and display
their fancy foods and
rich properties, they
thereby invite thievery.
This is acting
unnaturally.

And their granaries are
empty
The elite wear
generously-decorated
and expensive clothes
Sharp swords hang on
their waists
They stuff and they
swill
They lose themselves
in possession and
wealth
They flaunt their stolen
gear
Now, isn't that
conscienceless?

storehouses empty.
They wear elaborate
and embroidered robes;
they gird
themselves with sharp
swords; they eat and
drink with luxury; they
heap
up goods; they are
thievish and
vainglorious. All this is
opposite to
the Way of Tao.

but the fields are full of
weeds, and the
granaries are empty.
Some are beautifully
dressed and bejeweled,
wearing flashy
weapons on their belts,
eating and drinking
until they burst.
These people─these
state─sanctioned
crooks─
have far more than
they need.
Surely, this isn't the
Tao!

54. Power What is well established cannot be uprooted. What is firmly held cannot slip away. The power of sacrifice continues on from generation to generation. Cultivated in the person, power becomes real. Cultivated in the family, power becomes abundant. Cultivated in the community, power endures.	54 What is deeply rooted in Nature cannot be uprooted. He who embraces Nature's way as his own will not easily go astray; And his children and grandchildren will continue to emulate him. If one embodies Nature's way in his own life, he will be genuinely intelligent. If he establishes it in his family, his home life will be felicitous. If he cultivates it in he community, his future will be prosperous. If he fosters it in his state, his future will be auspicious.	54 One who is rooted in this unfair world, Won't be easy to unsettle One who holds on to that world, can't let go Therefore their children will suffer until the third and fourth generation But one who follows his conscience Will lead an impeccable life One who takes care that his fellow men follow their conscience, Makes them flourish One who takes care that his neighbours follow their conscience,	54. THE WITNESS OF WISDOM If a man plant according to the Tao it will never be uprooted; if he thus gather, it will never be lost. His sons and his son's sons, one following another, shall honour the shrine of their ancestor. The Tao, applied to oneself, strengtheneth the Body, to the	54
Cultivated in the nation, power flourishes. Cultivated in the world, power becomes universal. Therefore see the person as a person, the family as a family, the community as a community, the nation as a nation, and the world as universal. How do I know that the world is like this? By this.	If he inspires in in the whole country, his benefit will become universal. Thus one's own individual life serves as an example for other individuals. One's family life serves as an example for other individuals. One's family life serves as a model for other families. One's community serves as a standard for other communities. One's state serves as an ideal for other states. How do I know all this? It is obvious.	Makes them examples for everybody else And when all of mankind follows its conscience, There shall be a paradise on earth Look at yourself if you want to understand yourself Discover the connections and patterns in the way your nearest relations, Cities and the nations, get on with each other Because what's on a small scale, is on a big scale, too How do I know it is that way? Because I've done this myself	family, bringeth wealth; to the district, prosperity; to the state, great fortune. Let it be the Law of the Kingdom, and all men will increase in virtue. Thus we observe its effect in every case, as to the person, the family, the district, the state, and the kingdom. How do I know that this is thus universal under Heaven? By experience.	Kapitel nicht vorhanden / chapter not available

55.	55	55	55. THE SPELL OF THE MYSTERY	55
Know Harmony Those filled with power are like new-born children. Poisonous insects will not sting them; ferocious beasts will not pounce upon them; predatory birds will not swoop down on them. Their bones are pliable, their muscles tender, but their grip is firm. They have never known the union of man and woman, but the organ is fully formed, meaning that the vital essence is strong.	He who is intelligent is like a little child. Poisonous insects do not sting him. Ferocious beasts do not attack him. Wild birds do not claw him. His bones are soft, his muscles weak, yet is grip is strong. Because he has no urge for sexual union, he is fully satisfied. His vitality is intact.	A true human being is like a new-born baby Wasps and scorpions won't sting it, snakes and adders won't bite it Raptors and wild animals won't attack it Its bones and muscles are soft and flexible, yet it has a pretty tight grip Sex and libido are strange to it, but its little penis already is able to stiffen That is because its nature is not yet disturbed by thoughts	He that hath the Magick powers of the Tao is like a young child. Insects will not sting him or beasts or birds of prey attack him. The young child's bones are tender and its sinews are elastic, but its grasp is firm. It knoweth nothing of the Union of Man and Woman, yet its Organ may be excited. This is because of its natural perfection. It will	
They may cry all day without getting hoarse, meaning that the harmony is perfect. To know harmony is to be in accord with the eternal. To know the eternal is to be enlightened. To try to force life is ominous. To force the vital essence with the mind is violence. The prime is past, and decay follows, meaning that it is contrary to the Way. Whatever is contrary to the Way will soon perish.	He can cry all day without getting hoarse. His existence is harmonious. To know such harmony is to be in accord with Nature. To be in accord with Nature is to be achieving the goal of life. But to seek excitement is to invite calamity. Those too eager for activity soon become fatigued. For when things exhaust their vigour, they age quickly. Such impatience is against Nature. What is against Nature dies young.	It can yell all day without getting a hoarse throat Because everything is still perfectly in balance Experiencing that balance is called "living in the eternal present" Living without past or future is called "being wise" Every attempt to extend life is pointless One who wants to control his life, restrains oneself It is unnatural that things wither That which is unnatural will come to an early end	cry all day long without becoming hoarse, because of the harmony of its being. He who understandeth this harmony knoweth the mystery of the Tao, and becometh a True Sage. All devices for inflaming life, and increasing the vital Breath, by mental effort are evil and factitious. Things become strong, then age. This is in discord with the Tao, and what is not at one with the Tao soon cometh to an end.	Kapitel nicht vorhanden / chapter not available

56.
Mystical Unity
Those who know do
not speak.
Those who speak do
not know.
Close the mouth; shut
the doors.
Smooth the sharpness;
untie the tangles.
Dim the glare; calm the
turmoil.

56
He who is wise keeps
silent. He who advises
is a fool.
The wise man shuts his
mouth, Closes his
doors, Curbs his
anxieties, Withdraws
from entanglements,
Remains untempted by
attractions, And retains
his self-sufficiency.

56
Those who have
experienced the
Mystery don't speak
about it
Those who do speak
about it have not
experienced the
Mystery
Don't try to speak
about the Unspeakable
That which cannot be
seen, heard, felt or
tasted
The shapes fade
The edges weaken

56. THE
EXCELLENCE OF
THE MYSTERY
Who knoweth the Tao
keepeth Silence; he
who babbleth knoweth
it not.
Who
knoweth it closeth his
mouth and controlleth
the Gates of his Breath.
He will make his
sharpness blunt; he
will loosen his
complexes; he will

56
Those who know do
not tell. Those who tell
do not know.
Stop talking, withdraw
from the rat¹race,
calm your spirit,
untangle yourself,
soften your glare.
Be one with the dust of
the earth.

This is mystical unity.
Those achieving it are
detached from friends
and enemies,
from benefit and harm,
from honor and
disgrace.
Therefore they are the
most valuable people
in the world.

Nature is profoundly
impartial. It cannot be
persuaded by
pampering, Nor
dissuaded by scoffing.
It cannot be tempted by
bribes, Nor influenced
by injury. It cannot be
cajoled by flattery, Nor
chagrined by slander.
Thus it is the most
reliable thing in the
world.

Confusion disappears
The light brightens
The unrest is
extinguished
That's what they call a
"Mystical Experience"
Neither affection nor
hate can move him
Profit nor loss will
touch him
Honour nor disgrace
will harm him
Therefore he is the
world's noblest man

tone down his
brightness to the
general obscurity. This
is called the
Secret of Harmony.
He
cannot be insulted
either by familiarity or
aversion; he is immune
to
ideas of gain or loss, of
honour or disgrace; he
is the true man,
unequalled under
Heaven.

This is primal union.
Achieving union with
the Tao places one
beyond
attraction and
repulsion, benefit and
harm, honor and
disgrace.
This is the highest state
of being.

57. Love Peace States are governed by justice. Wars are waged by violations. The world is mastered by nonintervention. How do I know this? By this: The more restrictions there are, the poorer the people. The more sharp weapons, the more trouble in the state.	57 A good leader guides by example; A bad leader resorts to force and intrigue. Everything gains by noninterference. How do I know this? Consider the evidence: The more restrictions and taxes there are, the poorer the people become. The more weapons people possess, the more they fight. The more complicated machines become, the greater the danger from mechanical accident. The more laws are enacted and taxes assessed, the greater the number of law-breakers and tax-evaders.	57 With laws men rule a state With ruses people make war Without laws and without ruses you'll have a peaceful mankind How do I know this? Well, because of the following: The more orders and prescriptions, the more defiant the people become The more arming, the bigger the chaos The more knowledge and science, the more machines and artificiality	57. THE TRUE INFLUENCE One may govern a state by restriction; weapons may be used with skill and cunning; but one acquireth true command only by freedom, given and taken. How am I aware of this? By experience that to multiply restrictive laws in the kingdom impoverisheth the people; the use of machines causeth disorder in state and race alike. The more men use skill and cunning,	57 In governing, employ no surprises. In waging war, employ only surprises. Win the world with non-ado. How do I know this? Like this! The more rules and regulations there are, the poorer the people become. The more experts there are, the more confusion there is. The more skillful and clever technicians there are,
The more clever cunning, the more contrivances. The more rules and regulations, the more thieves and robbers. Therefore the wise say, "Do not interfere, and people transform themselves. Love peace, and people do what is right. Do not intervene, and people prosper. Have no desires, and people live simply."	This is why the intelligent man concludes: When I attend to my own business, other people are able to attend to theirs. When I exemplify self-reliance, other people will devote themselves to the exercise of their own intelligence. When I make no demands upon them, other people themselves will prosper. When I express no desire to interfere in their lives, others will become genuinely self-sufficient.	The more rules and decisions, the more thieves and robbers Therefore a wise man says: I don't do anything, and the people change spontaneously I take rest, and the people become honest spontaneously I don't make an issue of anything, and the people find wealth inside themselves I don't want anything, and the people return to simplicity	the more machines there are; and the more laws there are, the more felons there are. A wise man has said this: I will refrain from doing, and the people will act rightly of their own accord; I will love Silence, and the people will instinctively turn to perfection; I will take no measures, and the people will enjoy true wealth; I will restrain ambition, and the people will attain simplicity.	the more horrifying inventions are produced. The more "law and order" there is, the higher the crime-rate. Therefore, the Tao-Master says, I do nothing, and the people govern themselves. I practice keeping quiet, and the people find justice. I seek emptiness, and the people prosper. I have no desires, and the people return to a natural and simple life.

58. Results of Process When the government is relaxed, people are happy. When the government is strict, people are anxious. Good fortune leans on bad fortune; bad fortune hides behind good fortune. Who knows the results of process?	58 When government governs little, people are happy. When government governs much, people are miserable. Thus happiness depends on little, And misery depends on much. What does the desire to govern come to? To restrict interferers is itself interference. So attempts to increase happiness end only in misery. Mankind has been foolish for so long a time!	58 The fewer rules and laws there are, the happier mankind will be The more rules and laws, the more there will be of dissatisfaction and conflicts Someone's wealth comes at the expense of someone else's poverty	58. ADAPTATION TO ENVIRONMENT The government that exerciseth the least care serveth the people best; that which meddleth with everybody's business worketh all manner of harm. Sorrow and joy are bedfellows; who can divine the final result of either? Shall we avoid restriction? Yea; restriction distorteth nature, so that	58 When the government is restrained, the people are happy and satisfied. When the government meddles in everything, the people are disgruntled and miserable. Happiness eclipses misery. Misery eclipses happiness.
Is there no justice? When the just become unjust, goodness becomes evil. People have been deluded for a long time. Therefore the wise are square but not cornered, sharp but not cutting, straight but not strained, brilliant but not dazzling.	The intelligent man knows what is best, but does not make others conform. He knows directions, but does not direct. He pursues the straightest way to the goal, but does not urge others to deviate from their course. He is enlightened, but he cares not whether others see his light.	Misery for one is the result of someone else's wealth When will this ever stop? One who is wise is righteous and won't play that game He is just and fair and will never hurt anybody He shines, but does not blind	even what seemeth good in it is evil. For how long have men suffered from misunderstanding of this. The wise man is foursquare, and avoideth aggression; his corners do not injure others. He moveth in a straight line and turneth not aside therefrom; he is brilliant but doth not blind with his brightness.	Which will it be? The straight becomes crooked. Good becomes evil. The people remain bewildered. Thus, the Tao■Master is sharp but not cutting, incisive but not biting, straight but not controlling, bright but not glaring.

59. Be Frugal In leading people and serving heaven it is best to be frugal. Being frugal is to be prepared from the start. Being prepared from the start is to build up power. By building up power nothing is impossible.	59 In managing men or anything else, the intelligent man uses self-restraint. Only by self-restraint can one forestall trouble. Forestalling trouble strengthens one's position. Such strengthened position enables one to withstand everything. Withstanding everything, one remains unchallenged.	59 To get mankind to live in peace requires a full detachment Because only one who is detached knows how to live truthfully Letting go of everything before dying makes one live righteously One who lives righteously knows no trouble For one who knows no trouble, life is unbounded	59. WARDING THE TAO . To balance our earthly nature and cultivate our heavenly nature, tread the Middle Path. This Middle Path alone leadeth to the Timely Return to the True Nature. This Timely Return resulteth from the constant gathering of Magick	59 In governing the country and serving Heaven, show restraint. Showing restraint is submission to the Tao. Submission to the Tao will fill you with Te. Being filled with Te, there will be no limit to your power, and there will be nothing you cannot overcome. When there is nothing you cannot overcome,
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If nothing is impossible, then there are no limits. Those without limits are capable of leading a country. Those with maternal leadership can long endure. This is to be deeply rooted in a firm foundation, the way of long life and eternal vision.	Being unchallenged, one governs easily. Because he embodies Mother Nature within himself, he retains a sound position. This is the way to be deeply rooted and firmly based, And durable and long-lived.	One who is unbounded, considers the world as his home One who feels united with creation, lives happily ever after Then you'll be rooted again and you'll stand firmly Only like that will you live happily ever after and understand everything	Powers. With that Gathering cometh Control. This Control we know to be without Limit and he who knoweth the Limitless may rule the state. He who possesseth the Tao continueth long. He is like a plant with well- set roots and strong stems. Thus it secureth long continuance of its life.	you will be a true ruler indeed. You will be one with the country. You will be the Mother of the country. Being the Mother of the country, you will have deep roots and a firm base. Your reign will be long■lasting. This is the Tao of long life and eternal vision.
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60.
Spirits
Leading a large
country is like cooking
a small fish.
When the world is led
in accord with the
Way,
spirits lose their
powers.
It is not that they lose
their powers,

60
Whether governing a
big country or cooking
a little fish, follow
Nature's way and no
evil tendencies will get
control.

60
Making sure that
mankind lives in peace
is a trifle
Where righteousness is
the main guide,
delusions won't last
Not that there will be
no delusions at all
But the people will be
less susceptible to
them

60. THE DUTY OF
GOVERNMENT
The government of a
kingdom is like the
cooking of fish.
If
the kingdom be ruled
according to the Tao,
the spirits of our
ancestors will not
manifest their Teh.
These spirits have this
Teh, but

60
Rule a large country as
you would cook a
small fish.
Follow the Tao, and
evil will be subdued.

but that their powers
no longer harm people.
Not only do the spirits
not harm people,
but the wise also do not
harm people.
Not harming each
other, spiritual power
grows.

This does not mean
that the dangers of
evils can be eliminated
entirely, but only that
they will cease to harm
men.
When ordinary men
are unharmed, their
leaders are unharmed.
And when nobody
harms anybody, perfect
harmony prevails.

Delusions damage
people, and a wise man
shows them it's so
Therefore a wise man
is a threat to delusion,
But no threat for
mankind
Therefore they will
become wise, too

will not turn it against
men. It is able to hurt
men; so also is the
Wise King; but he doth
not.
When
these powers are in
accord, their Good
Will produceth the
Teh,
endowing the people
therewith.

Evil will still be there,
but it won't be able to
do much harm.
The Tao ■ Master does
no harm.
If no harm is done,
then the power of the
Tao can flow on.

61.
Large and Small
Countries
A large country is like
low land where rivers
flow,
a place where
everything comes
together, the female of
all.
The female overcomes
the male with
tranquillity.
Tranquillity is
underneath.
A large country wins
over a small country
by placing itself below
the small country.

61
To be great, a state
must be passively
receptive, like the
ocean which accepts
whatever the rivers
bring into it, or like the
feminine which always
submits to the
masculine. Recall how
the female always
overcomes the male by
means of her passivity.
Passivity is
submissiveness.

61
When mankind lives in
peace,
There will be no
superiors and inferiors
It is like a big river,
In which all side
currents have come to
rest
The wildness comes to
rest in peacefulness,

61. THE MODESTY
OF THE THE
A state becometh
powerful when it
resembleth a great
river, deep-seated;
to it tend all the small
streams under Heaven.
It
is as with the female,
that conquereth the
male by her Silence.
Silence is a form of
Gravity.
Thus
a great state attracteth
small states by meeting
their views, and

61
A great country is like
a sea into which all
streams flow,
the Female of the
world.
The Female overcomes
the Male with stillness.
The woman overcomes
the man by lying
underneath him.
Therefore, a great
country dominates a
small country by
submitting to it;

A small country wins
over a large country
by placing itself below
the large country.
Thus some win by
placing themselves
below,
and others win by
being below.
A large country wants
to protect people,
and a small country
wants to join and
serve.
Thus both get what
they want.
It is best for the large
country to place itself
below.

Thus the great state
places itself at the
service of a small state
before before it
absorbs the small state.
And a small state must
serve the interests of
the great state before it
can be taken into the
great state.
Hence, some submit in
order to take, while
others submit in order
to be taken.
When a great state
desires to have more
people, and a small
state desires to be
protected,
it is by submission that
both obtain what they
desire.

Because it is calm and
most lowly
One who is the least by
his disarming
simplicity,
Is therefore appealing
to his fellow men
And so it's a benefit for
both of them
So one who looks big,
has to become small
again

small states attract the
great state by revering
its eminence. In the
first case this Silence
gaineth supporters; in
the second, favour.
The
great state uniteth men
and nurtureth them; the
small state wisheth
the good will of the
great, and offereth
service; thus each
gaineth its
advantage. But the
great state must keep
Silence.

and a small country
can dominate a great
country by submitting
to it.
Yield and conquer.
A great country wants
to unite and shelter
people.
A small country wants
to come in and be
sheltered.
Each gets what it
wants.
Thus, the great country
should yield.

62.

The Way is Valued
The Way is sacred to
all things.
It is treasure for the
good and sanctuary for
the bad.
Fine words can buy
honor.
Good deeds can gain
respect.
Though there be bad
people, why reject
them?
Therefore at the
crowning of the
emperor

62

Nature is profoundly
worth while. It is that
which is most worth
while for good men,
And it is the only real
value for bad men.
Flattery may gain
favours, and gifts may
help one to advance,
But bad men know
how to flatter and
bribe.

62

Everything inclines
towards the original
balance
It's the bliss of true
men
It's a sanctuary for the
untruthful
But people flaunt
themselves with
flattery
They only do nice
things in exchange for
gratitude
Everybody does that so
why shouldn't you?
Therefore the people
shout with joy when a
new leader comes on
the scene

62. THE WORKINGS
OF THE TAO
The Tao is the most
exalted of all things. It
is the ornament of the
good, and the
protection and
purification of the evil.
Its
words are the fountain
of honour, and its
deeds the engine of
achievement. It is
present even in evil.
Though
the Son of Heaven
were enthroned with
his three Dukes
appointed to
serve him, and he were
offered a round
symbol- of-rank as
great as might

62

The Tao is the source
of all things,
the good man's
treasure, the bad man's
refuge.
You can buy beautiful
words.
You can build your
reputation with good
deeds.
But even bad people
can use beautiful
words and perform
good deeds.
So when the new
emperor is crowned

or at the installation of
the three ministers,
instead of sending gifts
of jade and a team of
four horses,
remain still and send
the Way.
Why did the ancients
prize this Way?
Did they not say,
"Seek, and you will
find;
let go, and you will be
forgiven."
Therefore the Way is
valued by the world.

Therefore when leaders
are installed in office,
Better than he who
artfully gives lavish
gifts and glowing
tribute, Is one who, by
doing nothing but
accepting his natural
role as a follower, pays
genuine homage.
Why have men always
valued Nature? Was it
not because Nature
submitted humbly to
the task of benefiting
the good and the bad
alike? Is this not the
reason why it is the
most worth while thing
in the world?

And let themselves be
fooled by pomp and
circumstance
It's wise not to
participate in this
Do you know why the
former wise people
considered simplicity
so important?
Because they
experienced that, one
who seeks will find
And that the truth sets
one free from past and
future
Therefore simplicity is
most important in this
life

fill the hands, with a
team of horses to
follow, this gift were
not to be
matched against the
Tao, which might be
offered by the
humblest of men.
Why
did they of old time set
such store by the Tao?
Because he that
sought it might find it,
and because it was the
Purification from all
evil. Therefore did all
men under Heaven
esteem it the most
exalted of
all things.

(and the three ministers
of state are installed),
do not send gifts of
jade and four horse
chariots.
Instead, be still, and
offer the Tao.
The ancients treasured
the Tao because, when
you seek it, you find it;
through the Tao, even
sinners receive
forgiveness.
That is why everybody
loves the Tao.

63. The Wise Never Strive Act without interfering. Work without doing. Taste the tasteless. Large or small, many or few, repay injury with goodness. Handle the difficult while it is still easy. Handle the big while it is still small. Difficult tasks begin with what is easy.	63 Act disinterestedly - without intending that your action shall change the course of Nature. Behave indifferently - without trying to impose your own ideas upon the lives of others. Appreciate natural flavours - without adulterating natural foods with artificial flavours. Accept the fact that what is small grows big, and what are few become many. Respond intelligently even to unintelligent treatment.	63 Act without intention Stop labouring Just enjoy life One who doesn't honour something small Isn't worthy of something big No more eye for an eye and tooth for a tooth Turn to them your other cheek Discover that what seems complicated is in fact very simple See the grandeur in what seems insignificant Don't turn simplicity into complexity	63. FORETHOUGHT AT THE OUTSET Act without lust of result; work without anxiety; taste without attachment to flavour; esteem small things great and few things many; repel violence with gentleness. Do great things while they are yet small, hard things while they are yet easy; for all things, how great or hard soever, have a beginning when	63 Act without ado; work without effort. Taste the tasteless; treat the small as large and the few as many. Reward evil with goodness. Take on the difficult while it is still easy, the large while it is still small. Difficult always begins as easy; large always begins as small.
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Great accomplishments begin with what is small. Therefore the wise never strive for the great and thus achieve greatness. Rash promises inspire little trust. Taking things too lightly results in much difficulty. Thus the wise always confront difficulties and therefore have no difficulty.	The most difficult things in the world Must be accomplished through the easiest. The greatest things in the world Must be accomplished through the smallest. Therefore the intelligent man, although never troubling himself with big things, still accomplishes the same result (by dealing with them when they are small) He who is careless about things when they are easy will have to face them when they become difficult.	Living purely is simple But people have made it complicated So one who's wise will never make trouble And therefore he can move mountains One who promises a lot is hardly ever trustworthy One with a lot of blinkers on will bring to pass lots of troubles But one who is wise looks before he leaps Therefore he won't start at all And because of that he knows no trouble	they are little and easy. So thus the wise man accomplisheth the greatest tasks without undertaking anything important. Who undertaketh thoughtlessly is certain to fail in attainment; who estimateth things easy findeth them hard. The wise man considereth even easy things hard, so that even hard things are easy to him.	Therefore, the Tao■Master never tries to be great. As a result, he accomplishes great things. Big promises produce little trust. Treating something as quite easy makes it very difficult. The Tao■Master regards everything as difficult, which means that, for him, everything is easy.
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64. Do Not Grab What stays still is easy to hold. Without omens it is easy to plan. The brittle is easy to shatter. The minute is easy to scatter. Handle things before they appear. Organize things before there is confusion. A tree as big as a person's embrace grows from a tiny shoot. A tower nine stories high begins with a mound of earth. A journey of a thousand miles begins under one's feet. To act is to fail. To grab is to lose.	64 That which remains quiet is easy to handle. That which has not yet developed is easy to manage, That which is weak is easy to control. That which is still small is easy to direct. Deal with little troubles before they become big. Attend to little problems before they get out of hand. For the largest tree was once a sprout, The tallest tower started with a single brick, And the longest journey began with a first stem. Just as he who tries to hasten what is natural, must fail in his attempt, So he who tries to retard what is natural, must fail in his attempt.	64 Peace is easy to keep What might happen is easy to prevent That which is fragile is easy to break What's still very small, can be chased away easily A big tree starts with a small seed A terrace-yard started with a mound of earth A thousand-mile journey starts with a single step One who disturbs the natural order, harms oneself One who intervenes loses oneself A wise man abstains far from this	64. ATTENDING TO DETAILS It is easy to grasp what is not yet in motion, to withstand what is not yet manifest, to break what is not yet compact, to disperse what is not yet coherent. Act against things before they become visible; attend to order before disorder ariseth. The tree which filleth the embrace grew from a small shoot; the tower nine-storied rose from a low foundation; the ten-day journey began with a single step.	64 That which is lying still is easy to pick up. That which has not yet happened is easy to prevent. That which is brittle is easily shattered. That which is small is easily scattered. Deal with things before they become problems. Straighten things out before they become confused. A huge tree begins as a tiny sprout. A terrace nine storeys high begins as a small pile of dirt. The giant pine tree grows from a tiny sprout. A thousand■mile journey begins with a single step.
Therefore the wise do not act and do not fail. They do not grab and do not lose. In handling things people usually fail when they are about to succeed. Be as careful at the end as at the beginning, and there will be no failure. Therefore the wise desire to have no desires. They do not value rare treasures. They learn what is unknown, returning to what many have missed so that all things may be natural without interference.	Since the intelligent man does not seek to accelerate, he does not make waste, And since he does not try to restrain, he does not fail. People are as likely to go wrong in not letting things come to their normal conclusions as they are in not letting them start in their own way. The intelligent man has no desire to redirect and no desire for what is hard to get. He has learned to be unlearned, and returned to the way which learned men have forgotten. He lets each thing develop in its own way, without any attempt to intervene.	Therefore he won't hurt himself and so he remains himself But people break down everything and they call it "progress" Once started, there is no end to A wise man strives for what others don't And takes to be important what others take to be unimportant He unlearns what other are still learning And turns back to a state of mind others have left Then he knows the way back to the source But realizes that the people do not want to hear about it	He who acteth worketh harm; he who graspeth findeth it a slip. The wise man acteth not, so worketh no harm; he doth not grasp, and so doth not let go. Men often ruin their affairs on the eve of success, because they are not as prudent at the end as in the beginning. The wise man willeth what others do not will, and valueth not things rare. He learneth what others learn not, and gathered up what they dispise.	Intrude and ruin. Grasp and lose. Therefore, the Tao■Master practices non■ado and so does not ruin; he is not grasping and so does not lose. People often fail just when they are about to succeed. Be as careful at the end as you are at the beginning, and you will not fail. Therefore, the Tao■Master desires no■desire, treasures no treasures, studies no studies. He pays attention to what others have ignored. He helps all things find their center, all without ado.

65. Know the Eternal Standard The ancients who ruled skillfully did not try to enlighten people but kept them in the dark. People are hard to lead when they are too clever. Those who lead with cleverness rob the country.	65 Originally people knew how to follow Nature, For they did not try to arouse in the people an interest in cunning, but let them remained unspoiled. The shrewder people are, the harder they are to govern. Therefore to try to improve government by means of increasing cleverness in people is to endanger it. But to improve government by encouraging honesty in the people is beneficial.	65 The former sages, who travelled along the straight and simple path Brought the people wisdom instead of knowledge When people know much, unity is impossible to keep That's why science disturbs the togetherness of men	65. THE PURITY OF THE THE They of old time that were skilled in the Tao sought not to enlighten the people, but to keep them simple. The difficulty of government is the vain knowledge of the people. To use cleverness in government is to scourge the kingdom; to use simplicity is	65 The ancient rulers who followed the Tao did not try to enlighten the people, but rather aimed at making them dull. People are hard to govern because they are so clever. Rulers who seek to enlighten the people are like bandits who prey upon the land.
Those who lead without cleverness bless the country. Understanding these two is to know the eternal standard. Knowing the eternal standard is mystical power. Mystical power is deep and far-reaching, leading all things to return to perfect harmony.	The comprehend the significance of these two ways is to be profoundly intelligent. Profound intelligence is that penetrating and pervading power To restore all things to their original harmony.	And wisdom guards that togetherness One who understands this Understands that wisdom and knowledge are in conflict with each other Once you understand this, you'll be wise And you will turn back to simplicity And feel one with everything and everybody	to anoint it. Know these things, and make them thy law and thine example. To possess this Law is the Secret Perfection of rule. Profound and Extended is this Perfection; he that possesseth it is indeed contrary to the rest, but he attracteth them to full accordance.	Rulers who forget about enlightening the people are a real blessing to the nation. Remember these two enduring principles: they represent the power [Te] of the Tao. Te goes deep and far. All things turn back and reach original harmony.

66.
Leading from Behind
Great rivers and seas
are lords of all
mountain streams,
because they are good
at staying below them.
Therefore they are
lords of the streams.
Thus the wise in
watching over the
people
speak humbly from
below the people,

66
Rivers and seas
dominate the
landscape, Because, by
being good at seeking
the lowest places, they
fill and occupy and
spread over everything.
Likewise the intelligent
man is superior to
others, Because he
admits that he is
inferior, And he is a
leader of others
Because he is willing
to be a follower.

66
Why are the seas and
rivers the biggest
among all waters?
Because they are
located on the lowest
places
Therefore they are the
biggest
So one who is wise
among fools must be
the least

66. PUTTING ONE'S
SELF LAST
The oceans and the
rivers attract the
streams by their skill in
being
lower than they; thus
are they masters
thereof. So the Wise
Man, to be
above men, speaketh
lowly; and to precede
them acteth with
humility.

66
Great rivers and seas
are kings to hundreds
of lesser streams
because they lie lower
than the lesser streams.
To stand above, you
must speak from
below.
To lead, you must
follow behind.
This is how the ruler
who follows the Tao

and in leading the
people get behind
them.
In this way the wise
watch over the people
but do not oppress
them;
they lead the people
but do not block them.
Thus everyone happily
goes along without
getting tired.
Because they do not
compete,
the world cannot
compete with them.

Thus although he is
actually superior to
others, they do not feel
depressed. And when
he leads them, they do
not feel that they are
being forced to obey.
So all are happy to give
him their support.
Since he competes
with no one, no one
competes with him.

And therefore he is the
greatest
But fools won't
consider him as a
threat
They just don't
understand him and
take no notice of him
Because he doesn't
fight and argue with
anybody, he is
indisputable

Thus,
though he be above
them, they feel no
burden; nor, though he
precede them, do they
feel insulted.
So
then do all men delight
to honour him, and
grow not weary of him.
He
contendeth not against
any man; therefore no
man is able to contend
against him.

stands above and leads
the people.
And in this way,
the people are neither
overburdened nor
oppressed.
The whole nation
supports such a ruler.
He contends with no
one, and no one
contends with him.

67.
Three Treasures
Everyone says the Way
is great and beyond
comparison.
Because it is great, it
cannot be compared.
If it were compared, it
already would have
seemed small.
I have three treasures
to be maintained and
cherished:
the first is love;
the second is frugality;
the third is not pushing
oneself ahead of
others.

67
Everyone says:
"Nature is great, yet
Nature is simple." It is
great because it is
simple. If it were not
simple, long ago it
would have come to
little.
Nature sustains itself
through three precious
principles, which one
does well to embrace
and follow. These are
gentleness, frugality
and humility.

67
In life I am great, but
to the world I am a
failure
In my grandeur, I am
different from all the
rest
And that is exactly
therefore the reason I
am great
If I would be like the
rest, I would be just as
unimportant and
insignificant
I have three treasures I
cherish:
The first is compassion
The second is austerity
The third is modesty
Thanks to my
compassion I can be
brave
Because I am austere I
can be unselfish

67. THE THREE
JEWELS
They say that while
this Tao of mine is
great, yet it is inferior.
This
is the proof of its
greatness. If it were
like anything else, its
smallness would have
long been known.
I
have three jewels of
price whereto I cleave;
gentleness, economy,
and
humility.

67
Many consider my
teaching to be
nonsense.
But the profound is a
lot like nonsense.
If a teaching does not
seem nonsensical, then
it must be trivial.
I have three treasures
to guard and preserve:
The first is
compassion.
The second is
self-restraint.
The third is not
wanting to be ahead of
others.
Compassion breeds
fortitude.

From love comes
courage;
from frugality comes
generosity;
from not pushing
oneself ahead of others
comes leadership.
Now courage without
love, generosity
without frugality,
and leadership by
pushing oneself ahead
of others are fatal.
For love wins all
battles and is the
strongest defense.
Heaven gives love to
save and protect.

When one is gentle, he
has no fear of
retaliation. When one
is frugal, he has no fear
of retaliation. When
one is humble, no one
challenges his
leadership.
When rudeness
replaces gentleness,
And extravagance
replaces frugality, and
pride replaces
humility, The one is
doomed.
Since a gentle attack
arouses little
antagonism, And a
gentle defense
provokes little anger,
Nature predisposes to
gentleness those most
suited for survival.

Because I am modest I
can lead the way
But one who abandons
his compassion and yet
wants to be brave
One who renounces
austerity and yet wants
to be unselfish
One who stops being
modest and still wants
to be important
Won't make it far
One who fights with
compassion, will
conquer
Because he doesn't
need to defend himself,
he's invulnerable
The Unspeakable will
protect him with its
compassion

That
gentleness maketh me
courageous, that
economy generous,
that
humility honoured.
Men of today abandon
gentleness for
violence, economy
for extravagance,
humility for pride: this
is death.
Gentleness
bringeth victory in
fight; and holdeth its
ground with
assurance. Heaven
wardeth the gentle man
by that same virtue.

Self-restraint breeds
generosity.
Not wanting to be
ahead of others breeds
leadership.
These days, people
want courage without
compassion,
generosity without
self-restraint, and
leadership without the
willingness to be led.
This is death.
Compassion rules!
On the attack, it wins.
On the defense, it
holds the fort.
It is Heaven's means of
aid and protection.

68. The Power of Not Striving The best soldier is not violent. The best fighter is not angry. The best winner is not contentious.	68 The best soldier does not attack. The superior fighter succeeds without violence. The greatest conqueror wins without a struggle. The most successful manager leads without dictating.	68 One who fights for peace is non-violent A true fighter is unshakeable A true victor does not argue A true leader is the least That's what people call "non-violent defensibility"	68. ASSIMILATING ONE'S SELF TO HEAVEN He that is skilled in war maketh no fierce gestures; the most efficient fighter bewareth of anger. He who conquereth refraineth from engaging in	68 The best soldier does not rush into battle. The best fighter does not display his anger. The best conqueror does not take vengeance on his enemy.
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The best employer is humble. This is known as the power of not striving, as ability in human relations, and as being in accord with heaven.	This is called intelligent nonaggressiveness. This is called mastery of men. This is called matching the wisdom of the highest and oldest in Nature.	And that's how one gets the people on his side That is called "living according to your nature" That is the perfection of which the wise of old spoke	battle; he whom men most willingly obey continueth silently with his Work. So it is said: 'He is mighty who fighteth not; he ruleth who uniteth with his subjects; he shineth whose will is that of Heaven.'	The best leader is the best follower. This is known as the power [Te] of not contending. This is known as true leadership. This is known as following Heaven's lead.
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69. The Kind Win The strategists say, "Do not be the aggressor but the defender. Do not advance an inch, but retreat a foot instead." This is movement without moving, stretching the arm without showing it,	69 Military maxims say: "It is easier to defend than to attack." "It is better to back away a foot than to assault to gain an inch." This means that the best way to advance is to retreat. He who bares his flesh will appear to have no need for carrying weapons. He who does not flourish weapons appears to have nothing to defend. He who does not prepare to defend himself appears to have no enemies.	69 One who understands that quarrels will never solve anything, Won't start them anymore and prefers to wait He rather takes a step back or retracts That's what people call winning by losing Showing strength without impressing	69. THE USE OF THE MYSTERIOUS WAY A great strategist saith: 'I dare not take the offensive. I prefer the defensive. I dare not advance an inch; I prefer to retreat a foot.' Place therefore the army where there is no army; prepare for action where there is no engagement; strike where there is no conflict; advance	69 There is a saying among military strategists: "Instead of advancing, I'll be advanced upon; it is better to retreat a foot than to advance an inch." This is known as advancing without advancing, getting ready without showing your muscles,
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confronting enemies with the idea there is no enemy, holding in the hand no weapons. No disaster is greater than underestimating the enemy. Underestimating the enemy will destroy my treasures. Thus when the battle is joined, it is the kind who will win.	No one will attack a person unless he appears to be an enemy, For to attack one who is not an enemy is to lose a friend. Therefore, when opposing enemies meet for open battle, he who runs away to hide is the one who wins.	Standing firm without starting a fight Nothing is more disastrous than underestimating your enemy One who underestimates his enemy exposes oneself to danger Therefore he who's driven by compassion Is always the winner in a conflict	against the enemy where the enemy is not. There is no error so great as to engage in battle without sufficient force. To do so is to risk losing the gentleness which is beyond price. Thus when the lines actually engage, he who regretteth the necessity is the victor.	capturing without attacking, being well■armed without weapons. There is nothing worse than underestimating your enemy. That leads to total defeat. Therefore, when armies clash, it is the side that does not rejoice in war■making that wins.
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70. My Ideas Are Easy My ideas are easy to understand and easy to practice. Yet no one understands them or practices them. My ideas have a source; my actions have a master.	70 The things I am saying are very easy to understand and very easy to practice. Yet no one in the world can comprehend them fully nor practice them perfectly.	70 My words are easy to comprehend And easy to bring to practice Yet no one in the world wants to surrender to them And no one feels capable of living according to them My words have an origin, my way of living a principle	70. THE DIFFICULTY OF RIGHT APPREHENSION My words are easy to understand and to perform; but is there anyone in the world who can understand them and perform them? My words derive from a creative and universal Principle, in accord with	70 My teachings are very easy to understand and even easier to put into practice. And yet, no one understands or practices them. My teachings are derived from an ancient system of principles.
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Because people do not understand this, they do not know me. Since few know me, I am very precious. Therefore the wise wear coarse clothes and keep the jewel inside.	The things I am saying did not originate with me but have their source in Nature. It is because men do not understand this source that they do not understand me. Since those who understand me are few, they are, for that reason, all the more worthy of emulation. Therefore the intelligent man presents a poor exterior, yet carries Nature's riches embedded in his core.	But because the people do not dare to see this They are not able to understand me There are only a few who understand me and to them I am most precious One who is wise therefore acts unnoticed, but remains oneself	the One Law. Men, not knowing these, understand me not. Few are they that understand me; therefore am I the more to be valued. The Wise Man weareth sack-cloth, but guardeth his jewel in his bosom.	People who do not realize this do not really know me. Few know me, but that is my value. Therefore, the Taoist Master wears rough clothing, but has a jewel for a heart.
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71.
A Disease
To know that you do
not know is the best.
To think you know
when you do not is a
disease.
Recognizing this
disease as a disease is
to be free of it.

71
To know how little one
knows is to have
genuine knowledge.
Not to know how little
one knows is to be
deluded.

71
Realizing you can't
know anything, is wise
One who does not
understand he can't
know anything, is
insane
One who realizes his
insanity,

71. THE DISTEMPER
OF KNOWLEDGE
To know, yet to know
nothing, is the highest;
not to know, yet to
pretend
to knowledge, is a
distemper.

71
To know that you do
not know is strength.
Not knowing that you
do not know is a
sickness.

The wise are free of
disease,
because they recognize
the disease as a
disease.
Therefore they are free
of disease.

Only he who knows
when he is deluded can
free himself from such
delusion. The
intelligent man is not
deluded, because he
knows and accepts his
ignorance, and accepts
his ignorance as
ignorance, and thereby
has genuine
knowledge.

Is able to get rid of it
One who is wise is not
insane anymore,
Because he has
disposed of his insanity
Therefore he has a
clear view

Painful
is this distemper;
therefore we shun it.
The wise man hath it
not. Knowing it to be
bound up with Sorrow,
he putteth it away from
him.

The cure begins with
the recognition of the
sickness.
The Taoist Master is not
sick, but he is sick of
sickness.
Thus, he is well.

72. Do Not Suppress When people lack a sense of awe, then something awful will happen. Do not constrict people's living space. Do not suppress their livelihoods.	72 Do not be irritated when people do not recognize your importance; For if you are really important, sooner or later circumstances will force them to recognize it. Do not treat them contemptuously nor despise them; For only when you do not despise them will they not despise you.	72 When people have forgotten what to be afraid of, They will live in vague fear Why do they come to terms with this miserable way of living? Why don't they see the beauty of life?	72. CONCERNING LOVE OF SELF When men fear not that which is to be feared, that which they fear cometh upon them. Let them not live, without thought, the superficial life. Let them not weary of the Spring of Life!	72 When the people do not fear your power, then your power has become truly great. Do not intrude into their homes. Do not interfere with their work.
If you do not harass them, they will not harass you. Therefore the wise know themselves but do not display themselves. They love themselves but do not exalt themselves. They let go of one and accept the other.	Although the intelligent man knows his own importance, He does not require that others recognize it; and he esteems himself for what he is, But does not insist that others esteem him. He does not seek to be esteemed by others because he recognizes his self-esteem as sufficient.	Why are they so scared of escaping their rut? One who is wise understands this, and won't flaunt it He enjoys it but doesn't consider it as his own merit He abandons his old way of living and embraces true life	By avoiding the superficial life, this weariness cometh not upon them. These things the wise man knoweth, not showeth: he loveth himself, without isolating his value. He accepteth the former and rejecteth the latter.	If you do not oppress them, then they will not become sick of you. Thus, the Tao■Master knows himself, but does not show himself. He loves himself, but is not arrogant. Therefore, he lets go of that and chooses this.

73. The Way of Heaven Those brave in killing will be killed. Those brave in not killing will live. Of these two, one is good, and one is harmful. Some are not favored by heaven. Who knows why? Even the wise consider it a difficult question.	73 He whose courage expresses itself as defiance is often put to death. He whose courage manifests itself as patience to endure insult continues to live. Of these two kinds of courage, the one is beneficial, the other harmful. Many people are puzzled as to why, of two courageous men, one is harmed and one benefited. But the intelligent man finds no difficulty with this question.	73 Having guts and being reckless will lead to death Having guts and being cautious saves life The first is useless; the other useful Only one who is wise understands the course of things Therefore he won't intervene	73. ESTABLISHING THE LAW OF FREEDOM One man, daring, is executed; another, not daring, liveth. It would seem as if the one course were profitable and the other detrimental. Yet when Heaven smiteth a man, who shall assign the cause thereof? Therefore the sage is diffident.	73 A man of daring courage will kill or be killed. A man of cautious courage seeks to save lives. Each of these may be either beneficial or harmful. Heaven hates what it hates. Who knows why? Even the Tao■Master can't figure it out.
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The Way of heaven does not strive; yet it wins easily. It does not speak; yet it gets a good response. It does not demand; yet all needs are met. It is not anxious; yet it plans well. The net of heaven is vast; its meshes are wide, but nothing slips through.	Nature itself has the patience to endure insult, yet always wins in the end. It does not explain; nevertheless all understand. It does not command; but all eventually obey. It does not hurry; yet everything is accomplished. Nature's web is so finely woven - wide enough to catch the biggest, fine enough to catch the smallest - that not a single thing escapes.	It is easy to infringe upon the eternal laws of nature But they always triumph They don't speak, yet they do answer They don't yell, yet everybody hears them Like a net, the original order protects the Universe Though its meshes seem wide, nothing can come through	The Tao of Heaven contendeth not, yet it overcometh; it is silent, yet its need is answered; it summoneth none, but all men come to it of their free will. Its method is quietness, yet its will is efficient. Large are the meshes of Heaven's Net; wide open, yet letting none escape.	The Tao does not contend, but it prevails. It does not speak, but it answers. It is not called, but it responds. It has no purpose, but it achieves all of its aims. Heaven's net is wide; nothing slips through.
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74.
Death
People are not afraid to die.
So why threaten them with death?
If people were afraid of death,
and lawbreakers could be caught and put to death,
who would dare to do so?

74
It is futile to threaten people with death. If they are not afraid to die, they cannot be frightened by the death penalty; and if they are afraid to die, why should we kill them?

74
When people no longer fear death
How can one threaten them with it?
But if people are afraid of death and other people threaten to kill them
When they infringe upon the law
Well, who is still going to break the law?
But there is only One who commands life and death

74. A RESTRAINT
OF
MISUNDERSTANDING
The people have no fear of death; why then seek to awe them by the threat of death? If the people feared death and I could put to death evil-doers,
who would dare to offend?

74
If people do not fear death,
then you cannot threaten them with it.
If they are afraid of death,
we could make death the penalty for breaking the law.
But do we dare to do so?

There is the Lord of Death who executes.
Trying to do his job is like trying to cut wood for the Master Carpenter.
Those who try to cut wood for the Master Carpenter
rarely escape injuring their own hands.

Only Nature knows the proper time for a man to die. To kill is to interrupt Nature's design for dying, Like a blundering apprentice judging himself to be wiser than his master.
Whenever an apprentice thinks he is smarter than his master, he is very likely to hurt himself.

Since people started to decide about life and death themselves
They have actually taken a place on that One's chair
Then they behave like sorcerer's apprentices
Who assault the works of their master,
With disastrous consequences for themselves

There is one appointed to inflict death. He who would usurp that position
resembleth a hewer of wood doing the work of a carpenter. Such an one,
presumptuous, will be sure to cut his own hands.

Consider the role of the official executioner:
Are you ready to play that role?
When amateurs try to play the master carpenter,
they usually cut and bruise themselves in the process.

75. Valuing Life People are hungry, because rulers eat too much tax-grain. That is why people are starving. People are hard to govern, because rulers interfere too much. That is why they are hard to govern.	75 Those who make their living by collecting taxes cause the people to starve; when the people starve, the tax collectors, having no one to tax, starve also. Those who govern people make them discontented with being controlled; and therefore cause them to be uncontrollable.	75 People starve Because the wealthy enrich themselves off other people's backs That's why people starve People cannot be kept under control Because their leaders don't know what they're doing	75. THE INJURY OF GREED	75 When taxes are too high, people starve. When the government is too intrusive, it makes life no longer worth living, and
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People do not care about death, because rulers demand too much of life. That is why they do not care about death. Only those who do not interfere with living are best at valuing life.	Those who are so eager to make a better living that they risk death in doing so are the very ones most likely to die. Only the self-sufficient person who depends upon and endangers no one else in order to get his living is most sure to live.	That's why people cannot be kept under control People want to die Because they don't want to live this way Therefore people want to die Only the one who is not afraid to live, Is not afraid of dying	In such a state of insecurity it is better to ignore the question of living than to set store by it.	the people lose their love of life and their fear of death. To promote the value of life, do not interfere with it.
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76.
Life Is Tender
When people are born,
they are tender and
supple.
At death they are stiff
and hard.
All things, like plants
and trees,
are tender and pliant
while alive.
At death they are dried
and withered.

76
At birth a man is soft
and weak - yet capable
of living the whole life
ahead of him. At death
he is hard and tough -
yet unable to live for
even a minute longer.
All things, whether
plants of animals,
while living, are soft
and weak, But, when
dead, are hard and
tough.

76
When a human being is
born, it's supple and
weak
When it dies it's stiff
and strong
Everything that's alive
(take a look at grass
and trees for example)
Is supple and flexible
And when they die
they are shriveled and
parched

76. A WARNING
AGAINST RIGIDITY
At the birth of man, he
is elastic and weak; at
his death, rigid and
unyielding. This is the
common law; trees
also, in their youth, are
tender and supple; in
their decay, hard and
dry.

76
People are born soft
and flexible;
when they are dead,
they are hard and stiff.
Living plants are
tender and pliant;
when they are dead,
they are brittle and
dried out.
Therefore, whatever is
hard and stiff is a sign
of death.

Therefore the stiff and
hard are companions of
death.
The tender and supple
are companions of life.
Thus strong arms do
not win.
A stiff tree will break.
The hard and strong
will fall.
The tender and supple
will rise.

Thus hardness and
toughness are allied
with death, While
softness and weakness
are interrelated with
life.
This is the reason why
the tougher fighters are
more likely to be
killed, and the harder
trees more likely to be
cut down.
Therefore it is better to
be soft and weak than
to be hard and tough.

Therefore hardness and
inflexibility are
companions of death
And suppleness and
softness, companions
of life
That's why a rigid
troublemaker will
never win
And an inflexible tree
is doomed to death
Inflexibility and power
won't get you very far
Suppleness and
softness get you
everywhere

So
then rigidity and
hardness are the
stigmata of death;
elasticity and
adaptability, of life.
He
then who putteth forth
strength is not
victorious; even as a
strong
tree filleth the
embrace.
Thus
the hard and rigid have
the inferior place, the
soft and elastic the
superior.

Whatever is soft and
flexible is a sign of
life.
An army without
flexibility never wins.
An unbending tree is
easily brought down by
the wind.
The hard and stiff fall.
The soft and flexible
rise.

77.

Taking and Giving
The Way of heaven is
like bending a bow.
The high is lowered;
the low is raised.
The excessive is
reduced; the deficient
is increased.
The Way of heaven
takes from those who
have too much
and gives to those who
do not have enough.
The human way is
different.

77

Nature's way is like the
bending of a bow: The
top which is high is
lowered while the
bottom which is low is
raised, And the width
which is narrow is
widened while the
length which is long is
shortened.
Nature's way is to take
from those that have
too much and give to
those that have too
little.

77

The natural order is
like stretching a bow
The low bow gets
pushed up high
And the high tendon
pulled downwards
Where there is too
much, it takes away
Where there is not
enough, it fills
Nature strives for
harmony all the time
Decreases where there
is too much
And increases where
there is too little
But how opposite are
the people in their
behaviour

77. THE WAY OF
HEAVEN

The Tao of Heaven is
likened to the bending
of a bow, whereby the
high
part is brought down,
and the low part raised
up. The extreme is
diminished, and the
middle increased.
This
is the Way of Heaven,
to remove excess, and
to supplement
insufficiency. Not so is
the way of man, who
taketh away from him
that

77

The Tao is like the
bending of a bow.
The top is bent
downward; the bottom
is bent up.
If the cord is too long,
it is shortened;
if it is too short, it is
lengthened.
The policy of the Tao
is to take from those
who have too much
and give to those who
have too little.
But that is not the
human practice.

It takes from those who
do not have enough
and gives to those who
have too much.
Who has more than
enough to give to the
world?
Only the person of the
Way.
Therefore the wise act
but do not rely on their
own ability.
They accomplish the
task but claim no
credit.
They have no desire to
seem superior.

Man's way, on the
contrary, is to take
away from those who
have too little to give
more to those who
already have too much.
What kind of man is
able to take away from
his own more than
enough and give to
others who have less
than enough?
Only he who embodies
Nature's way within
himself. Such a man
gives his gift without
desiring a reward,
achieves benefit for
others without
expecting approbation,
And is generous
without calling
attention to his
generosity.

The poor get poorer
while the rich tend to
get richer
But one who is wise
realizes that possession
is burglary to
community
Therefore he disposes
himself of that which
belongs to the
community
So only one who is
wise is detached
He does what others
ask him to, but nothing
for himself
Without taking credit
for it

hath not to give to him
that hath already
excess.
Who
can employ his own
excess to the weal of
all under Heaven?
Only he
that possesseth the
Tao.
So
the Wise Man acteth
without lust of result;
achieveth and boasteth
not; he willeth not to
proclaim his greatness.

We take from those
who have too little
and give to those who
have too much.
Who is it that has more
than enough
and gives his surplus to
those in need?
Only the follower of
the Tao.
The follower of the
Tao acts without hope
of gain,
accomplishes but takes
no credit,
does not wish to lord it
over others.

78. The Soft and Weak Nothing in the world is softer and weaker than water. Yet nothing is better at attacking the hard and strong. There is no substitute for it. The weak overcomes the strong; the soft overcomes the hard.	78 Nothing is weaker than water; Yet, for attacking what is hard and tough, Nothing surpasses it, nothing equals it. The principle, that what is weak overcomes what is strong, And what is yielding conquers what is resistant, Is known to everybody. Yet few men utilize it profitably in practice.	78 Nothing in life is so soft and compliant as water Nothing is stronger in breaking what is hard and strong Nothing can exceed it in doing this Weak overcomes strong Soft overcomes hard Nobody knows this	78. A CREED Nothing in the world is more elastic and yielding than water; yet it is preeminent to dissolve things rigid and resistant; there is nothing which can match it. All men know that the soft overcometh the hard, and the weak conquereth	78 Water is soft and yielding, but nothing can more effectively dissolve the hard and inflexible. Weak defeats strong. Soft defeats hard. This is well known, but not easy to put into practice. Therefore, the Tao Master says:
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Everyone knows this, but no one puts it into practice. Therefore the wise say, "Those who bear the humiliation of the people are able to minister to them. Those who take upon themselves the sins of the society are able to lead the world." Words of truth seem paradoxical.	But the intelligent man knows that: He who willingly takes the blame for disgrace to his community is considered a responsible person, And he who submissively accepts responsibility for the evils in his community naturally will be given enough authority for dealing with them. These principles, no matter how paradoxical, are sound.	And no one practices it Therefore the sage says: One who is the least in the world, will be the greatest in life One who carries the sorrow of the world, is the greatest among mankind It sounds odd, but it's true	the strong; but none are able to use this law in action. A Wise Man hath said: 'He that taketh on the burden of the state is a demigod worthy of sacrificial worship; and the true King of a people is he that undertaketh the weight of their sorrows.' Truth appeareth paradox.	He who takes upon himself the dirt of the nation becomes the master of its sacred soil; he who takes upon himself the evils of the land becomes a true king under Heaven. Straight words seem crooked.
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79. Stay with the Good Compromising with great hatred surely leaves some hatred. How can this be considered good? Therefore the wise keep their part of an agreement	79 Make agreements and then quarrelling when they are broken is never advisable. For even when a quarrel is patched up, some animosity will remain. How can this be considered good? Therefore the intelligent man continues to carry out his side of a bargain Even though he does not demand of others that they fulfill their promises	79 When people make peace after violent hostility Then it's an armed peace How can it be right? One who is wise only takes a look at his own share in the conflict And never blames his opponent	79. TRUTH IN COVENANT When enemies are reconciled, there is always an aftermath of illwill. How can this be useful? Therefore, the Wise Man, while he keepeth his part of the record of a transaction, doth not insist on its prompt execution. He who hath the	79 Great resentment, even when appeased, does not go away. How can this be good? Therefore, the Tao■Master keeps his promises, but he does not look into whether others are keeping theirs.
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and do not blame the other party. The good fulfill their obligations; the bad exact obligations from others. The Way of heaven is impartial. It always stays with the good.	The righteous insist on keeping agreements to the letter, And the indiscreet foolishly neglect or break their agreements; But Nature neither keeps nor breaks contracts (because it makes none). And its ways are good for men.	So one who is fair only faces his own part While one who is not daring enough to look at oneself, blames the other The road to self-knowledge knows no partiality But it does benefit the sincere	Teh considereth the situation from all sides, while he who hath it not seeketh only to benefit himself. In the Tao of Heaven, there is no distinction of persons in its love; but it is for the True Man to claim it.	The man of virtue (Te) monitors himself; The man without virtue monitors others. The Tao of Heaven plays no favorites, but it is always manifest in the good man.
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80. Home Is Comfortable In a small country with few people machines that can work ten or a hundred times faster are not needed. People who care about death do not travel far. Even if there are ships and carriages, no one takes them. Even if there are armor and weapons, no one displays them.	80 The ideal state is a small intimate community Where all the necessities of life are present in abundance. There everyone is satisfied to live and die without looking around for greener pastures. Even if they have cars or boats, they do not use them for travelling abroad. Even if they have police and fortifications, these are never put to use.	80 May mankind live in freedom, equality and brotherhood again, So that there will be no need for leaders and superiors Then people won't fear death any longer And won't try to escape death May it be that people don't feel the need anymore, To move themselves about in vehicles And that they will have nothing to defend anymore May humankind abandon their instruments and machines,	80. ISOLATION In a little kingdom of few people it should be the order that though there were men able to do the work of ten men or five score, they should not be employed. Though the people regarded death as sorrowful, yet they should not wish to go elsewhere. They should have boats and wagons, yet no necessity to travel; corslets	80 Imagine a small country with a small population. They have lots of technology, but they use none of it. They take the prospect of death seriously and thus do not travel far from home. They have boats and carriages, but no one takes them out. They have weapons and armor, but no one takes them out of the armory. Instead of writing, they have gone back
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People return to knotted rope for records. Food is tasty; clothes are beautiful; home is comfortable; customs are delightful. Though neighboring communities see each other and hear each other's cocks crowing and dogs barking, they may grow old and die without going there.	Business transactions are simple enough to be calculated on one's fingers rather than requiring complicated bookkeeping. The people are satisfied with their food, Contented with their clothing, Comfortable in their dwellings, And happy with their customs. Even though neighbouring communities are within sight, And the crowing of the neighbour's cocks and barking of the neighbour's dogs are within hearing, They grow old and die without ever troubling themselves to go outside of their own communities.	And enjoy the seeds of the fruit-bearing plants Those were meant as our food May they feel shamelessly proud of their natural beauty again May they stop locking themselves away in cities and houses, And start enjoying creation And if some fools still lock themselves away in nations, Civilizations, cities and houses May the wise men keep themselves far from this, And live happily ever after	and weapons, yet no occasion to fight. For communication they should use knotted cords. They should deem their food sweet, their clothes beautiful, their houses homes, their customs delightful. There should be another state within view, so that its fowls and dogs should be heard; yet to old age, even to death, the people should hold no traffic with it.	to the old system of cord-knotting. They enjoy their plain but good food, their simple but fine clothing, their humble but secure homes. They are happy with their way of life. The next country is so close that the crowing of the cocks and the barking of the dogs over there can be easily heard over here; and yet the people over here grow old and die without ever having been over there.
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81. True Words True words are not beautiful. Beautiful words are not truthful. The good do not argue. Those who argue are not good. Those who know are not scholarly. The scholarly do not know.	81 He who is genuine is not artificial; He who is artificial is not genuine. He who is intelligent is not quarrelsome; He who is quarrelsome is not intelligent. He who is wise is not pretentious; He who is pretentious is not wise.	81 True words are not pretty Pretty words are not true Wise men do not talk about the Unspeakable One who talks about the Unspeakable is not wise Wise men are not learned And learned ones aren't wise A wise man doesn't gather possessions	81. THE SHEWING-FORTH OF SIMPLICITY True speech is not elegant; elaborate speech is not truth. Those who know do not argue; the argumentative are without knowledge. Those who have assimilated are not learned; those who are gross with learning have	81 True words aren't pretty; pretty words aren't true. The good do not contend; those who contend aren't good. The wise are not learned; the learned are not wise. The Tao■Master is not greedy.
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The wise do not hoard. The more they give to others, the more they have. The Way of heaven sharpens but does no harm. The Way of the wise accomplishes without striving. © Sanderson Beck, 1996	Therefore the intelligent man does not struggle to achieve for himself. The more useful he is to others, the more his needs will be cared for by those repeatedly benefited by his yielding. Nature's way is to produce good without evil. The intelligent man's way is to accept and follow Nature rather than to oppose Nature.	He gives what he has And therefore he is worthy of living He shares his wisdom with others His wisdom is never-ending Living according to nature never harms The life of a wise man is unselfish and peaceful	not assimilated. The Wise Man doth not hoard. The more he giveth, the more he hath; the more he watereth, the more is he watered himself. The Tao of Heaven is like an Arrow, yet it woundeth not; and the Wise Man, in all his Works, maketh no contention.	The more he does for others, the more he has. The more he gives to others, the richer he becomes. The Tao sharpens without cutting. The Tao■Master acts with non■ado. [no frames]
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Chapter 1

George Cronk

1
The Tao that can be
defined is not the real
Tao.
The name that can be
named is not the real
Name.
The unnamable [Tao]
is the source of Heaven
and Earth.
Naming is the mother
of all particular things.
Free from desire, you
experience reality.

Trapped in desire, you see only appearances. Reality and appearance have different names, but they emerge from the same source [i.e., the Tao].

This source is called darkness, deep darkness; and yet it is the way to all wisdom.

2.	2	2	2. THE ENERGY - SOURCE OF THE SELF	2
Relativity and Not Interfering	It is because we single out something and treat it as distinct from other things that we get the idea of its opposite. Beauty, for example, once distinguished, suggests its opposite, ugliness.	When people think `this´ is beautiful, they must think `that´ is ugly When people say `this´ is good, than they have to say `that´ is evil This is Inevitable People create a false reality out of the real one Hard and easy are relative Long and short depend upon each other High and low are determined by a position	All men know that beauty and ugliness are correlatives, as are skill and clumsiness; one implies and suggests the other. So also existence and non-existence pose the one the other; so also is it with ease and difficulty, length and shortness; height and lowness. Also Musick exists through harmony of opposites; time and space depend upon contraposition.	No beauty without ugliness. No good without evil. Being and non-being are two aspects of the same reality. Difficult and easy, long and short, high and low, before and after: With each pair, two sides of the same coin.. Therefore, the Tao Master acts with non-do [wuwei]
When the people of the world all know beauty as beauty, there arises the recognition of ugliness. When they all know the good as good, there arises the recognition of bad. Therefore being and non-being produce each other; difficult and easy complete each other; long and short contrast each other; high and low distinguish each other; sound and voice harmonize with each other;	And goodness, when we think of it, is naturally opposed to badness. In face, all distinctions naturally appear as opposites. And opposites get their meaning from each other and find their completion only through each other. The meaning of "is" and "is not" arise from our distinguishing between them.			
beginning and end follow each other.	—	Sound and voice need one another	By the use of this method, the sage can fulfil his will without action, and utter his word without speech.	and teaches without speaking.
Therefore the wise manage affairs without interfering	—	Before and beyond assume a point of view	All things arise without diffidence; they grow, and none interferes; they	Things come and go. He lets them come and go.
and teach beyond the words.	—	That's why a wise man acts without intentions	change according to their natural order, without lust of result.	He creates, but he does not own.
All things rise, and they do not turn away from them.	—	And won't decide for others what to do	The work is accomplished; yet continueth in its orbit, without goal.	He achieves, but he takes no credit.
They give them life, but do not take possession of them.	—	He'll let anything happen as it happens	This work is done unconsciously; this is why its energy is indefatigable.	He completes his work and then forgets about it.
They act, but do not rely on their own ability.	—	He won't consider what he does as his own merit		Practice non-do, and your accomplishments endure.
They accomplish, but claim no credit.	—	And only therein is he praiseworthy		
Because they claim no credit,	—			
their accomplishment remains with them.	—			
	—			
	—			
	—			
	—			

3.	3	3	3. QUIETING FOLK	3
Simplicity	If no distinctions of superiority and inferiority prevail among officers, they will devote themselves to their tasks rather than to rivalries with one another.	When you praise people for their achievements, people will compete	To reward merit is to stir up emulation; to prize rarities is to encourage robbery; to display desirable things is to excite the disorder of covetousness.	Glorify the superior, hatch jealousy and competition.
Do not exalt the worthy,		When you call things valuable, people will steal		Value possessions, provoke stealing.
so that people will not compete.		When people flaunt desirable things, it will make other people restless	Therefore, the sage governeth men by keeping their minds and their bodies at rest, contenting the one by emptiness, the other by fullness. He	Stimulate desire, enflame the passions.
Do not value rare treasure,	If no special value is placed upon rare things, one will have no incentive for stealing them.	Therefore the sage sets himself to the task of emptying their heads		Therefore, the Tao■Master would rule
so that people will not steal.				by emptying minds and filling bellies,
Do not display objects of desire,				
so that people's hearts will not be disturbed.	If nothing appears to arouse envy, one will remain satisfied with things as they are			
Therefore the wise lead by keeping				

their hearts pure, their bellies full,	Since this is so, the wise administrator does not lead people to set their hearts upon what they cannot have, but satisfies their inner needs. He does not promote ambition to improve their status, but supports their self-sufficiency. He does not complicate their lives with knowledge of multifarious details or with an urge to attend to this, that and the other.	To make sure they're not hungry, discourage their ambitions and strengthen their bodies	satisfieth their desires, thus fulfilling their wills, and making them frictionless; and he maketh them strong in body, to a similar end.	by weakening desire and strengthening bodies.
their ambitions weak, and their bones strong,		So people will be without anxiety and without the desire for knowledge	He delivereth them from the restlessness of knowledge and the cravings of discontent. As to those who have knowledge already, he teacheth them the	He would lead the people away from knowing and wanting and would try to prevent those with knowledge from interfering.
so that the people may be purified		And the scientists will be played off the field	way of non-action. This being assured, there is no disorder in the	Practice non■ado, and everything will fall into place.
of their thoughts and desires;		When people won't labour anymore	world.	
and the cunning ones will not interfere.		All will live in peace		
By acting without interfering, all may live in peace.	By keeping people contented, he prevents those who mistakenly believe that ambition is better than contentment from leading the contented astray.			

4. The Infinite Way The Way is infinite; its use is never exhausted. It is bottomless, like the fountainhead of all things. It smoothes its roughness; it unties its tangles.	4 Nature contains nothing but natures; and these natures are nothing over and above Nature. In Nature, all natures originate, all conflicts are settled, all differences are united, all disturbances are quieted.	4 That which maintains the Creation Is like an empty barrel that's inexhaustible It is like a fathomless emptiness, filling the whole Creation Its sharpness brings about curves Its angles dissolve	4. THE SPRING WITHOUT SOURCE The Tao resembleth the emptiness of Space; to employ it, we must avoid creating ganglia. Oh Tao, how vast art Thou, the Abyss of Abysses, thou Holy and Secret Father of all Fatherhoods of Things!	4 The Tao is empty: used but never used up. It is the bottomless source of all things. It blunts sharp edges, unties knots, softens glare, clears dust.
It softens its light; it calms its turmoil. Deep and still, ever present. I do not know its source. It seems to have existed before the Lord.	Yet no matter how many natures come into being, they can never exhaust Nature. To look for an external source of Nature is foolish, for Nature is the source of all else.	It dims its light It restrains its touch How pure and calm it stays, like deep waters I don't know its origin It seems like it is even older than that by which it is brought forth	Let us make our sharpness blunt; let us loosen our complexes; let us tone down our brightness to the general obscurity. Oh Tao, how still art thou, how pure, continuous One beyond Heaven! This Tao hath no Father; it is beyond all other conceptions, higher than the highest.	It is hidden, but always present. I don't know its mother. It is older than the gods [if there are any gods].

5. Emptiness and the Center Nature is not humane. It treats all things like sacrificial objects. The wise are not humane. They regard people like sacrificial objects.	5 Opposites are not sympathetic to each other. Each one of the many kinds of opposites acts as if it could get along without its other. But Nature treats opposites impartially, dealing with each of every pair of opposites with the same indifference. And the intelligent man will regard opposites in the same manner.	5 The Creation does not pretend to be friendly It treats all things impartially One who is wise doesn't act friendly All people are equal to him The Universe is like bellows	5. THE FORMULA OF THE VACUUM Heaven and earth proceed without motive, but casually in their order of nature, dealing with all things carelessly, like used talismans. So also the sages deal with their people, not exercising benevolence, but allowing the nature of all to move without friction.	5 The Tao is impartial; it sees all things as straw [fake] dogs. The Tao■Master is also impartial; he regards people as straw dogs.
How the universe is like a bellows! While empty, it is never exhausted. The more it is worked, the more it produces. Much talk brings exhaustion. It is better to keep to the center.	No matter how deeply natures are torn by opposition, Nature itself remains unchanged. In conflicts between opposites, the more one attacks his seeming opponent (upon which he really depends for his completion), the more he defeats himself (and thereby demonstrates that only Nature, and not any opposite abstracted from existence, is self-sufficient). So, likewise, no matter how much debaters argue, their argument proves nothing. Things are what they are, regardless of how much we disagree about them.	Although empty, it fills continuously The harder it works, the more it brings forth The more you talk about it, the wearier you get Therefore, you'd better stick to what really matters	The Space between heaven and earth is their breathing apparatus: Exhalation is not exhaustion, but the complement of Inhalation, and this equally of that. Speech exhausteth; guard thyself, therefore, maintaining the perfect freedom of thy nature.	The Tao is like a bellows: it is empty yet infinitely available. It is always producing. Speak of it, fail to grasp it. Hold on to the center.

Chapter 6 Sanderson Beck	Chapter 6 Archie J. Bahm	Chapter 6 Anonymous	Chapter 6 Aleister Crowley	Chapter 6 George Cronk
6. The Mystical Female The spirit of the valley never dies. It is called the mystical female. The door of the mystical female	6 The tendency towards opposition is ever-present. Opposition is the source of all growth. And the principle of opposition is the source of all opposites.	6 The spirit of depth never dies People sometimes call it the Great Mother The gate through which she breathes	6. THE PERFECTING OF FORM The Teh is the immortal enemy of the Tao, its feminine aspect. Heaven	6 The valley spirit, the Great Mother: Her doorway is the channel from which
is the root of heaven and earth. It seems to be continuously within us. Use it, and it will never fail.	The principle of opposition is inherent in Nature, so oppositeness will continue forever, no matter how many opposites may come and go.	Is the foundation of Creation It appears to be everlasting When you rely on that, life will be effortless	and Earth issued from her Gate; this Gate is the Root of their World- Sycamore. Its operation is of pure Joy and Love, and faileth never.	Heaven and Earth came forth. She is always present and inexhaustible.

7.
Enduring
Heaven is eternal, and
the earth is very old.
They can be eternal
and long lasting,
because they do not
exist for themselves,
and for this reason can
long endure.
Therefore the wise put
themselves last,

7
The principle of
initiation persists; and
the principle of
completion continues.
Why do such opposing
principles persist?
Because they inhere in
Nature, rather than
stand by themselves.
That is why opposites
endure.

7
The Universe is
everlasting
The reason why it is
everlasting
Is because it doesn't
exist for itself
Therefore it can last
Therefore a wise man
behaves as the least

7. THE
CONCEALMENT OF
THE LIGHT
Heaven and Earth are
mighty in continuance,
because their work is
delivered from the lust
of result.
Thus
also the sage, seeking
not any goal, attaineth
all things; he doth

7
Heaven and Earth are
everlasting.
Since they were never
born, they will never
die.
They do not exist for
themselves and thus go
on forever.

but find themselves
foremost.
They are indifferent to
themselves,
and yet they always
remain.
Is it not because they
do not live for
themselves
that they find
themselves fulfilled?

The intelligent man,
when an issue arises,
stands off and observes
both contentions.
Since he does not take
sides, he never loses a
battle.
By not favouring one
side more than the
other, he is able to
appreciate the virtues
of both sides.

And because he is
least, he is the greatest
He is detached and
therefore he is safe
Couldn't it be possible
that he is perfect,
Just because he is
disinterested?

not interfere in the
affairs of his body, and
so that body acteth
without
friction. It is because
he meddleth not with
personal aims that
these
come to pass with
simplicity.

The Taoist Master stays
behind and is thus
ahead.
He is detached and is
thus one with all
things.
He is selfless and is
thus fulfilled.

8. The Best Are Like Water The best are like water. Water benefits all things and does not compete with them. It flows to the lowest level. In this it comes near to the Way. In their dwellings, they love the earth. In their hearts, they love what is profound.	8 The best way to conduct oneself may be observed in the behaviour of water. Water is useful to every living thing, yet it does not demand pay in return for its services; it does not even require that it be recognized, esteemed, or appreciated for its benefits. This illustrates how intelligent behaviour so closely approximates the behaviour of Nature itself.	8 A perfect human being is like the water That benefits all things and competes with nothing It stays in places which others despise But in this way it follows its origin In his heart the wise cherishes simplicity	8. THE NATURE OF PEACE Admire thou the High Way of Water! Is not Water the soul of the life of things, whereby they change? Yet it seeketh its level, and abideth content in obscurity. So also it resembleth the Tao, in this Way thereof! The virtue of a house is to be well-placed; of the mind, to be at ease in	8 It is good to be like water. It nourishes without effort. It flows without contention into low places that people scorn. Thus, it is like the Tao. In dwelling, live close to the land.
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In their friendship, they love humanity. In their words, they love sincerity. In government, they love peace. In business, they love ability. In their actions, they love timeliness. It is because they do not compete that there is no resentment.	If experience teaches that houses should be built close to the ground, That friendship should be based on sympathy and good will, That good government employs peaceful means of regulation, That business is more successful if it employs efficient methods, That wise behaviour adapts itself appropriately to the particular circumstances, All this is because these are the easiest ways. If one proceeds naturally, without ambition or envy, everything works out for the best.	In contact with others he is amiable In his words he is reliable In his leading he is peaceful In what he does he is competent He does everything at the moment it needs to be done He won't fight And therefore he is impeccable	silence as of Space; of societies, to be well-disposed; of governments, to maintain quietude; of work, to be skillfully performed; and of all motion, to be made at the right time. Also it is the virtue of a man to abide in his place without discontent; thus offendeth he no man.	In thinking, go deep. In relating to others, be gentle. In governing, seek good order and justice. In acting, be skillful. In working, do all things at the right time. No contention, no strife.
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9. Moderation Stretch a bow to the very full, and you will wish you had stopped in time. Temper a sword-edge to its very sharpest, and the edge will not last long.	9 Going to extremes is never best. For if you make a blade too sharp, it will become dull too quickly And if you hoard all the wealth, you are bound to be attacked.	9 It is better to carry an empty barrel than a full one Sharpen a knife until it is razor-sharp and it won't last long When a house is filled with valuables, it is impossible to guard	9. THE WAY OF RETICENCE Fill not a vessel, lest it spill in carrying. Meddle not with a sharpened point by feeling it constantly, or it will soon become blunted. Gold and jade endanger the house of their possessor. Wealth and honors	9 Fill your bowl all the way: it overflows. Keep sharpening your sword: it gets dull. Pile up gold and jade: it cannot be protected.
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When gold and jade fill your hall, you will not be able to keep them safe. To be proud with honor and wealth is to cause one's own downfall. Withdraw as soon as your work is done. Such is heaven's way.	If you become proud and arrogant regarding your good fortune, you will naturally beget enemies who jealously despise you. The way to success is this: having achieved your goal, be satisfied not to go further. For this is the way Nature operates.	When wealth and ambition make one arrogant, it will lead to a fall When fame and success menace you, pull back That's the only road to true bliss	lead to arrogance and envy, and bring ruin. Is thy way famous and thy name becoming distinguished? Withdraw, thy work once done, into obscurity; this is the way of Heaven.	Increase your wealth, status, and power: you suffer ruin. Do your work, then withdraw: that's the Way!
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10.	10	10	10. THINGS ATTAINABLE	10
Mystical Power	If you would retain a wholesome personality, must you not restrain your lower interests from dominating over your higher interests?	Can you empty your head and lastingly lose yourself in Creation?	When soul and body are in the bond of love, they can be kept together.	Can you keep body and soul together
Can you embrace the One with your soul, and never depart from the Way?		Can you live up to your nature and become like a child?		and find your wholeness in the One?
Can you concentrate your vital force	If you wish to live healthily, should you not breathe naturally, like a child, and not hold your breath until your vitality is nearly exhausted?	Can you purify the doors of perception and see clearly again?	By concentration on the breath it is brought to perfect elasticity, and one	Can you make your breathing as soft as a newborn child's?
to achieve the gentleness of a new-born baby?		Can you love your fellow man and serve mankind disinterestedly?	becomes as a babe. By purifying oneself from Samadhi one becomes whole	Can you cleanse your inner vision
Can you cleanse and purify your mystic vision	If you desire to realize the potentialities of your indescribable original nature, how can you insist that some selected aspect of your personality is really superior to that original nature?	Can you go in and out of the narrow gate without any effort?	In his dealing with individuals and with society, let him move without	until you see with perfect clarity?
until it is clear?		Can you be in the world without being possessed by it?		Can you love the people and govern the country without ado?
Can you love the people and govern the state				
without interfering?				

[illegible]

11. Use What Does Not Exist Thirty spokes are united around the hub of a wheel, but the usefulness of the wheel depends on the space where nothing exists. Clay is molded into a vessel, but the usefulness of the vessel	11 Every positive involves its negative or opposing factor; for example: In order to turn a wheel, although thirty spokes must revolve, the axle must remain motionless; so both the moving and the non-moving are needed to produce revolution. In order to mold a vase, although one must use clay, he must also provide a hollow space of empty clay; so both clay and the absence of clay are required to produce a vessel.	11 Thirty spokes unite within the nave But the wheel is only useful because of the cavity inside the nave Clay is kneaded into vases But the utility is determined by the cavity	11. THE VALUE OF THE UNEXPRESSED The thirty spokes join in their nave, that is one; yet the wheel dependeth for use upon the hollow place for the axle. Clay is shapen to	11 Thirty spokes are joined in the hub of the wheel, but it is the center hole, where it is empty, that makes the wheel useful. We make a clay pot, but it is the emptiness inside that makes the pot useful.
depends on the space where nothing exists. Doors and windows are cut out of the walls of a house, and the usefulness of the house depends on the space where nothing exists. Therefore take advantage of what exists, and use what does not exist.	In order to build a house, although we must establish solid walls, we must also provide doors and windows; so both the impenetrable and penetrable are essential to a useful building. Therefore, we profit equally by the positive and negative ingredients in each situation.	When building a house they leave blank spots in the walls for doors and windows But the utility of the house depends on the cavity inside Therefore, that which exists is useful But the cavity makes it possible	make vessels; but the contained space is what is useful. Matter is therefore of use only to mark the limits of the space which is the thing of real value.	We cut windows and doors to make a room, but it is the inner emptiness that makes the room useful. We seek to take advantage of what is, but we also find much use for what is not.

12. Satisfy the Inner Self The five colors blind the eyes; the five musical tones deafen the ears; the five flavors dull the taste. Racing and hunting madden the mind.	12 Interest in the varieties of colour diverts the eye from regarding the thing which is coloured. Attention to the differences between sounds distracts the ear from consideration for the source of the sounds. Desire for enjoyment of the various flavours misdirects the appetite from seeking foods which are truly nourishing.	12 All those artificial colours blind people's eyes All that man-made music deafens people's ears All those various flavours dull our taste Horse races and hunting drive people crazy The desire for scarce goods	12. THE WITHDRAWAL FROM THE EXTERNAL The five colors film over Sight; The five sounds make Hearing dull; The five flavours conceal Taste; occupation with motion and action bedevil	12 The five colors can make us blind. The five sounds can make us deaf. The five flavors can deaden our taste. Racing, chasing, and hunting can drive us mad.
Precious goods keep their owners on guard. Therefore the wise satisfy the inner self rather than external senses. They accept the one and reject the other.	Excessive devotion to chasing about and pursuing things agitates the mind with insane excitement. Greed for riches ensnares one's efforts to pursue his healthier motives. The intelligent man is concerned about his genuine needs and avoids being confused by dazzling appearances. He wisely distinguishes one from the other.	Hinders people from going on the straight and simple path Therefore the wise finds his satisfaction In feeding himself and then he won't exhaust his eyes Therefore he does this and leaves that	Mind; even so the esteem of rare things begetteth covetousness and disorder. The wise man seeketh therefore to content the actual needs of the people; not to excite them by the sight of luxuries. He banneth these, and concentrateth on those.	The pursuit of treasure knocks us off the path. Therefore, the Taoist Master follows his inner vision rather than his outer vision. He chooses this but not that.

13.
Selflessness
Good fortune and
misfortune cause
apprehension.
Regard great trouble as
you regard your self.
What is meant by
"Good fortune and
misfortune cause
apprehension?"
Those with good
fortune are
apprehensive of their
gain.
Those with misfortune
are apprehensive of
their loss.
What is meant by

13
Pride and shame cause
us much fearful
anxiety. But our inner
peace and distress
should be our primary
concerns.

13
Watch out for gratitude
and criticism
Honour and misfortune
are as disastrous as
having character
What does that say?
Watch out for gratitude
and criticism?
Watch out for
gratitude, because it
originates from
submission
Watch out for
criticism, because it
comes from superior
power
Therefore, watch out
for gratitude and
criticism

13. THE CONTEMPT
FOR
CIRCUMSTANCE

Favor and disgrace are
equally to be shunned;
honour and calamity to
be
alike regarded as
adhering to the
personality.

What
is this which is written
concerning favour and
disgrace? Disgrace
is the fall from favour.
He then that hath
favour hath fear, and
its
loss begetteth fear yet
greater of a further fall.
What is this which is

13

Being in favor or being in disgrace: either way, trouble.

It is all within the Self.

What does this mean?

Being in favor, we fear falling out of favor.

Being out of favor, we fear remaining there.

"Regard great trouble as you regard your self?"

Great trouble comes from being selfish.

Being selfless, what trouble is there?

Therefore those who value the world as themselves may be entrusted to govern the world.

Those who love the world as themselves may be entrusted to care for the world.

[illegible]

What does it mean that honour and misfortune are as bad as having character?

Disasters come over us because we've got something to lose

If we had nothing to lose, which disasters could still strike us?

Therefore: to him who considers himself just as worthy as the world, Mankind can entrust the world

And to him who loves himself and the world just as unconditionally, Mankind can entrust the care for the world

written concerning
honour and calamity?
It is this attachment to
the
body which maketh
calamity possible; for
were one bodiless,
what evil
could befall him?
Therefore
let him that regardeth
himself rightly
administer also a
kingdom; and let him
govern it who loveth it
as another man loveth
himself.

This fear is within the Self.

No Self, no fear.

Do you value the world as you value yourself?

You may be trusted to rule.

Do you love the world as you love yourself?

The world may be entrusted to your care.

14. The Formless Way We look at it, and do not see it; it is invisible. We listen to it, and do not hear it; it is inaudible. We touch it, and do not feel it; it is intangible. These three elude our inquiries, and hence merge into one. Not by its rising, is it bright, nor by its sinking, is it dark. Infinite and eternal, it cannot be defined.	14 Since what is ultimate in Nature cannot be seen with one's eyes, it is spoken of as invisible. Since it cannot be heard with one's ears, it is called inaudible. Since it cannot be grasped in one's hands, it is thought of as intangible	14 We look at it but we do not see it and we call it the invisible We listen to it but don't hear it and we call it the inaudible We grope at it but never touch it and we call it the untouchable The invisible, the inaudible and the untouchable come together in one There is no light when it rises There is no darkness when it descends Continuously, constantly, but it cannot be put into words	14. THE SHEWING-FORTH OF THE MYSTERY We look at it, and see it not; though it is Omnipresent; and we name it the Root-Balance. We listen for it, and hear it not, though it is Omniscient; and we name it the Silence. We feel for it, and touch it not, though it is Omnipotent; and we name it the Concealed. These three Virtues hath it, yet we cannot describe it as consisting of them; but, mingling them aright, we apprehend the One.	14 Look, but you can't see it. Listen, but you can't hear it. Reach out, but you can't touch it. Invisible, inaudible, intangible. Elusive. The One. When it rises, no light. When it sets, no darkness.
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It returns to nothingness. This is the form of the formless, being in non-being. It is nebulous and elusive. Meet it, and you do not see its beginning. Follow it, and you do not see its end. Stay with the ancient Way in order to master what is present. Knowing the primeval beginning is the essence of the Way.	Nature is the formless source of all forms, and yet it remains unaffected by its forms. Thus it appears to us as if mysterious. No matter how closely we scrutinize its coming toward us, we cannot discover a beginning. No matter how long we pursue it, we never find its end. One must comprehend the way in which the original Nature itself operates, if he wishes to control present conditions. That is, he should study the ultimate source itself. This is the way to understand how Nature behaves.	And it returns to nothing This is what they call the form of the formless, the image of the invisible People call it indefinite and impalpable You won't see it from the front You won't see it from behind One who lives after their original conscience, lives in the present And understands everything that has ever been That is living according to nature	Above, it shineth not; below, it is not dark. It moveth all continuously, without Expression, returning into Naught. It is the Form of That which is beyond Form; it is the Image of the Invisible; it is Change, and Without Limit. We confront it, and see not its Face; we pursue it, and its Back is hidden from us. Ah! but apply the Tao as in old Time to the work of the present; know it as it was known in the Beginning; follow fervently the Thread of the Tao.	It calls all things back into nothingness [No■Thing■Ness]. Formless form, imageless image. No front, no back. Live in the Tao of old, master the present. Know the Source: The essence of Tao.
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15.	15	15	15. THE	15
The Wise	In primitive times,	The wise of old were	APPEARANCE OF	The Tao■Masters of
The wise have ancient	intelligent men had an	profound and acute	THE TRUE NATURE	old had profound
mystic wisdom	intuitively penetrating	People thought of them	The adepts of past ages	wisdom and deep
and profound	grasp of reality which	as unfathomable	were subtle and keen to	understanding.
understanding, too	could not be stated in	Because they where	apprehend this	They were
deep to comprehend.	words.	unfathomable, I'll try to	Mystery,	unfathomable.
Because they can not	Since their instinctive	sketch their way of	and their profundity	We cannot
be comprehended,	beliefs have not been	living:	was obscurity unto	comprehend them; all
they can only be	recorded for us, we can	They seemed cautious,	men. Since then they	we can do is describe
described by analogy:	only infer them from	like people who cross a	were not	them:
cautious, like crossing	old sayings which have	wintry river	known, let me declare	Cautious, like someone
a stream in winter;	come down to us.	They seemed	their nature.	crossing an icy stream;
alert, like one aware of	Regarding caution	irresolute, as if danger	To	Alert, like someone
danger on all sides;	when crossing a stream	was threatening	all seeming, they were	sensing danger;
courteous, like a	in winter: the more	everywhere	fearful as men that	Courteous, like a
visiting guest;	nervous you are, the	They seemed dignified,	cross a torrent in	houseguest;
self-effacing, like ice	more likely you are to	as if they where guests	winter	Yielding, like melting
beginning to melt;	slip and fall: Regarding	They seemed natural,	flood; they were	ice;
genuine, like a piece of	suspicion of enemies;	like raw wood	hesitating like a man in	
uncarved wood;	the more you fear		apprehension of them	
	others, the more the		that are	
	will be afraid of you:		about him; they were	
	Regarding courtesy as		full of awe like a guest	
	a guest: the longer you		in a great house; they	
	stay, the more you		were	
	become indebted to			
	your host.			
open and receptive,	—	They seemed empty,	ready to disappear like	Undefined, like a piece
like a valley;	—	like a valley	ice in thaw; they were	of uncarved wood;
freely mixing, like	—	They seemed opaque,	unassuming like	Open, like a valley;
muddy water.	—	like muddy water	unworked	Murky, like muddy
Who can make sense	—	How can one make	wood; they were empty	water.
of a muddy world?	—	muddy water clear?	as a valley; and dull as	We must wait for the
Let it be still, and it	—	Stagnation will settle	the waters of a marsh.	water to settle; then it
becomes clear.	—	the mud down and the	Who	will be clear.
Who can remain calm,	—	water will become	can clear muddy	Can you keep still until
and through activity	—	clear	water? Stillness will	what is needed
come back to life?	—	Let everything happen	accomplish this. Who	becomes clear?
Those who embrace	—	as it happens and you	can	Those who follow the
this Way do not	—	will come to rest	obtain rest? Let motion	Tao are not full of
over-extend	—	The head of the wise is	continue equably, and	themselves.
themselves.	—	empty, he does not	it will itself be peace.	They are like durable
Because they do not	—	search for anything and	The	garments that need no
over-extend	—	expects nothing	adepts of the Tao,	renewal.
themselves,	—	He is empty,	conserving its way,	
they do not wear out	—	everlasting, youthful	seek not to be actively	
and are not replaced.	—	and not caught in time	self-	
	—	He is perfect	conscious. By their	
	—		emptiness of Self they	
	—		have no need to show	
	—		their youth and	
	—		perfection; to appear	
	—		old and imperfect is	
	—		their	

16. Know the Eternal Empty yourself of everything. Maintain a steady serenity. All things take shape and become active, but I see them return to their source, like vegetation that grows and flourishes, but returns to the root from which it springs. Returning to the source is serenity; it is to realize one's destiny. To realize one's destiny is to know the eternal. To know the eternal is to be enlightened.	16 In order to arrive at complete contentment, restrain your ambitions. For everything which comes into being eventually returns again to the source from which it came. Each thing which grows and develops to the fullness of its own nature completes its course by declining again in a manner inherently determined by its own nature. Completing its life is as inevitable as that each thing shall have its own goal. Each thing having its own goal is necessary to the nature of things.	16 One who has an empty head is satisfied, One who is satisfied has an empty head All creatures exert and come to rest All plants grow to maturity and come to rest That final rest is what's called being done; completion Returning to nature is what's called eternal life Living in the present is called being enlightened	16. THE WITHDRAWAL TO THE ROOT Emptiness must be perfect, and Silence made absolute with tireless strength. All things pass through the period of action; then they return to repose. They grow, bud, blossom and fruit; then they return to the root. This return to the root is this state which we name Silence; and this Silence is Witness of their Fulfilment. This cycle is the universal law. To know it is the part of intelligence;	16 Empty yourself. Be calm. The ten thousand things come and go. Just watch them. All things return to the Source, where there is stillness. To return to the Source is to recover what is permanent. Knowing what is permanent: enlightenment. Not knowing what is permanent: disaster.
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Not to know the eternal is to act blindly and court disaster. Whoever knows the eternal is open to everything. Whoever is open to everything is impartial. To be impartial is to be universal. To be universal is to be in accord with heaven. To be in accord with heaven is to be in accord with the Way. To be in accord with the Way is to be eternal and to live free from harm even though the body dies.	Being intelligent, he knows that each has a nature which is able to take care of itself. Knowing this, he is willing that each thing follow its own course. Being willing to let each thing follow its own course, he is gracious. Being gracious, he is like the source which graciously gives life to all. Being like the gracious source of all, he embodies Nature's way within his own being. And in thus embodying Nature's way within himself, he embodies its perpetually recurrent principles within himself.	One who is not enlightened lives in confusion and misery One who lives according to his nature understands everything and is forbearing One who is forbearing is righteous One who is righteous is royal One who is royal is divine One who is divine knows oneself One who knows oneself has eternal life One who has eternal life is not afraid to die	to ignore it bringeth folly of action, whereof the end is madness. To know it bringeth understanding and peace; and these lead to the identification of the Self with the Not-Self. This identification maketh man a king; and this kingliness groweth unto godhood. That godhood beareth fruit in the mastery of the Tao. Then the man, the Tao permeating him, endureth; and his bodily principles are in harmony, proof against decay, until the hour of his Change.	Knowing what is permanent opens the mind. Open mind, open heart. Open heart, magnanimity. Magnanimity, a virtue of queens and kings. A true queen or king lives in accord with Nature. To live in accord with Nature is to find the Tao. Following the Tao makes death harmless.
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17. Leaders The best leaders the people barely know. The next best they love and praise. The next they fear. And the next they hate.	17 The most intelligent leaders bring about results without making those controlled realize that they are being influenced. The less intelligent seek to motivate others by appeals to loyalty, honour, self-interest, and flattery. Those still less intelligent employ fear by making their followers think they will not receive their rewards. The worst try to force others to improve by condemning their conduct.	17 Of the wise of old, people only knew that they existed Later on they loved them and admired them Thereafter they got scared of them And finally the wise were seen as despicable	17. THE PURITY OF THE CURRENT In the Age of Gold, the people were not conscious of their rulers; in the Age of Silver, they loved them, with songs; in the Age of Brass, they feared them; in the Age of Iron, they despised them. As the rulers lost confidence, so also did the people lose confidence in them.	17 The best ruler: hardly known to exist. Next best: known and loved. Next best: feared. The worst: despised.
Those who lack trust will not be trusted. Then they resort to promises. But when they accomplish their task and complete their work, the people say, "We did it ourselves."	But since, if leaders do not trust their followers then their followers will not trust the leaders, The intelligent leader will be careful not to speak as if he doubted or distrusted his follower's ability to do the job suitably. When the work is done, and as he wanted it done, he will be happy if the followers say: "This is just the way we wanted it."	One who can't trust oneself, can't trust another How cautious were the first with their words They proceeded so cautiously that when they where done The people thought they did it themselves	How hesitating did they seem, the Lords of the Age of Gold, speaking with deliberation, aware of the weight of their word! Thus they accomplished all things with success; and the people deemed their well-being to be the natural course of events.	No trust given, no trust received. The best ruler rules without fanfare. When his work is successful, the people say, "Fantastic! We've done it!"

18. When the Way is Forgotten When the great Way is forgotten, the doctrines of humanity and morality arise. When knowledge and cleverness appear, there emerges great hypocrisy.	18 When people try to improve upon, and thus deviate from, the way Nature itself naturally functions, they develop artificial codes of right and wrong. When knowledge becomes highly abstract, men are deceived by mistaking abstractions for realities.	18 When people deviate from their nature Friendliness and righteousness became merits to be earned Knowledge and cleverness came into being and lying started to rule	18. THE DECAY OF MANNERS When men abandoned the Way of the Tao, benevolence and justice became necessary. Then also was need of wisdom and cunning, and all fell into	18 When the Tao is not followed, kindness and morality appear. When intelligence and learning are exalted, pretentiousness emerges.
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When family relationships are not in harmony, filial piety and parental love are advocated. When a country falls into chaos and disorder, there is praise of loyal patriots.	When instinctive family sympathies are replaced by rules for proper conduct then parents become "responsible" and children become "dutiful". When corruption replaces genuine benevolence in government, then loyalty oaths are demanded of officials.	Relatives came into conflict with each other and loving each other became a duty Cause when mankind and families get confused Allegiance becomes an order	illusion. When harmony ceased to prevail in the six spheres it was needful to govern them by manifesting Sons. When the kingdoms and races became confused, loyal ministers had to appear.	When there is no peace and order in the family, then we get all kinds of talk about "family values." When the country is badly governed and in chaos, we then glorify patriotism.
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19. What People Need Abandon religion and discard cleverness, and people will benefit a hundredfold. Abandon humanity and discard morality, and people will rediscover love and duty. Abandon skill and discard profit,	19 Therefore - If we ignore intricate learning and knowledge of petty distinctions, we shall be many times better off. If we neglect to insist upon the formal proprieties of etiquette, our intuitive sympathies will return.	19 Dispose yourself of worldly knowledge and cleverness And it will only be good for mankind Stop pretending to be nice and fair, but be it Then people will love each other unconditionally Dispose yourself of the work of your hands and stop serving your self-interest	19. RETURNING TO THE PURITY OF THE CURRENT If we forgot our statesmanship and our wisdom, it would be an hundred times better for the people. If we forgot our benevolence and our justice, they would become again like sons, folk of good will. If we	19 Discard learning and knowledge, and the people will be a hundred times happier. Banish kindness and morality, and the people will rediscover love and duty. Forget about industry and profit,
and there will be no thieves or robbers. These three things relate to externals and are inadequate. People need what they can depend on: reveal simplicity; embrace the natural; control selfishness; reduce desires.	If we abolish opportunities for profiteering "within the law," incentive for political corruption will disappear. If the foregoing three principles are unclear, then at least the following are understandable: Simply be yourself. Act naturally. Refrain from self-assertiveness. Avoid covetousness.	And there will be no thieves or robbers anymore But these three things won't be enough What it's really about is turning back to simplicity Giving up your selfishness and not wishing for anything	forget our machines and our business, there would be no knavery. These new methods despised the olden Way, inventing fine names to disguise their baneness. But simplicity in the doing of the will of every man would put an end to vain ambitions and desires.	and there won't be any thieves. When these three things are done, more will be required: Look at plain silk; hold uncarved wood; let self dwindle; let desire fade.

20.
Drawing Sustenance
Abandon memorizing,
and vexations end.
How much difference
is there between yes
and no?
How much difference
is there between good
and evil?
Is what people fear
really to be feared?
How very remote the
actual occurrence!
The people of the
world make merry
as though at a holiday
feast or a spring
carnival.
I alone am inactive and
desireless,
like a new-born baby
who cannot yet smile,
unattached, as though
homeless.

20

If we stop fussing about grammatical trivialities, we will get along much better. The difference between "Yes" and "ya" is insignificant as compared with a genuine distinction like "Good" and "Bad".

Yet some people are as fearful of making a grammatical mistake as of committing a vital error. How stupid to waste our lives in infinite details!

While others enjoy devoting themselves to ceremonious holiday celebrations, such as the spring festivals, I stay at home as unperturbed as a helpless babe.

20

When you unlearn
what you have learned,
you will be free from
worries

We've learned that
there is but little
difference between yes
and no, but

That there is a big
difference between
good and evil

That we have to be
scared of what others
are scared of

What an endless pack
of bullshit

Everybody is restless
and excited like they
are watching a soccer
game

Only I am at rest and
unwound and I don't
have to do those things
and like a child, I want
nothing

20. THE
WITHDRAWAL
FROM THE
COMMON WAY

To forget learning is to
end trouble. The
smallest difference in
words,
such as 'yes' and 'yea',
can make endless
controversy for the
scholar. Fearful indeed
is death, since all men
fear it; but the abyss of
questionings, shoreless
and bottomless, is
worse!

Consider
the profane man, how
he preeneth, as if at
feast, or gazing upon
Spring from a tower!
But as for me, I am as
one who yawneth,
without any

20

No more learning, no
more trouble.

Is there any real
difference between
"Ahhh!" and "Yuk!"?

What about "good" and
"evil"?

Must I fear what others
fear?

Ridiculous!

Everybody else is
smiling,
having fun as if at a
festival or carnival.

I alone am drifting, not
knowing whether I'm
coming or going,

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So while others are
feasting, I appear
neglected. Am I the
one who is a misguided
fool?

When everyone else is
exuberant, I continue
to be disinterested.

When everyone else is
alert to the niceties of
etiquette, I persist in
being indifferent. I am
as unconcerned as the
rolling ocean, without
a care to bother me.

While others behave
like busybodies, I
alone remain placid
and resist arousalment.

How can I withstand
the pressure of public
opinion? Because I am
succored by Mother
Nature herself.

I'm not attached to anything and don't have to go anywhere in particular

The others already have so much and still they want more

Only I seem to have lost everything

They think I'm crazy and confused

People seem to be bright and clever

And think that I am naive and foolish

It looks like I blow with the wind and don't seem to find rest anywhere

The others seem to know so much

And in their eyes I am nothing but a boor

I am only different because I live according to my nature

— like a baby before it
— has learned to smile.

— Others have what they
— need; I have nothing.

— I might as well be
— homeless.

— I'm a fool. Very
— confused.

— Others are bright; I am
— dim.

— Others are sharp; I am
— dull, lost at sea,
— without direction.

— Others have plans; I
— am aimless.

— I am different from
— others.

— I am nourished by the
— Great Mother.

21. Within the Elusive Way All-embracing power proceeds only through the Way. What is called the Way is elusive and intangible. Intangible and elusive, yet within it are thought-images. Elusive and intangible, yet within it are objects. Deep and obscure, yet within it is the life-force.	21 Intelligence consists in acting according to Nature. Nature is something which can neither be seen nor touched. Yet all of the forms which can possibly be seen or touched are latent within it. And all of the things that will actually be seen or touched are embedded as potentialities within it. Deep in its depths are activating forces. No matter how unplumbable the depths, these forces unfailingly sustain the world as it appears to us.	21 A righteous and blissful life is approachable only when you follow your conscience The conscience is invisible and impalpable. How can you follow it? It speaks through images, like shadows in the dark But how faintly and obscurely The conscience is hidden but it carries the essentials of everything inside	21. THE INFINITE WOMB The sole source of energy is the Tao. Who may declare its nature? It is beyond Sense, yet all form is hidden within it. It is beyond Sense, yet all Perceptibles are hidden within it. It is beyond Sense, yet all Perceptibles are hidden within it. It is beyond Sense, yet all Being is	21 Te flows from Tao. Tao is elusive and evasive. Evasive and elusive, yet within it there are ideas. Elusive and evasive, yet within it are entities. Dark and obscure, yet within it there is life.
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The life-force is very real, and within it is certainty. From the ancient times till now its manifestations have never ceased, by which we may see the beginning of all things. How do I know that the beginnings of all things are so? Through this certainty.	From the beginning until now, they have never ceased to express themselves in appearances. How do I know all this to be so? It is intuitively self-evident, for every existing thing testifies to it, including what appears right here and now.	The true life-force shelters itself inside conscience Everything people know deeply inside is stowed within the conscience It has always been there since the beginning, with many different names The conscience separates truth from lie How do I know all this? My conscience has told me that it's so	hidden within it. This Being excites Perception, and the Word thereof. As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be, its Name operateth continuously, causing all to flow in the cycle of Change, which is Love and Beauty. How do I know this? By my comprehension of the Tao.	The life of the Tao is so real; it gives rise to certainty. From the beginning until now, it has appeared in countless forms, it has been given countless names. How do I know this? Like this!
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22. Yielding for Unity To yield is to preserve unity. To bend is to become straight. To empty oneself is to become full. To wear oneself out is to be renewed. To have little is to be content. To have abundance is to be troubled. Therefore the wise embrace the One and become examples for the world. They do not display themselves and are therefore illumined.	22 Submit to Nature if you would reach your goal. For, whoever deviates from Nature's way, nature forces back again. Whoever gives up his desire to improve upon Nature will find Nature satisfying all his needs. Whoever finds his desires extinguished will find more desires arising of their own accord. Whoever desires little is easily satisfied. Whoever desires much suffers frustration. Therefore, the intelligent person is at one with Nature, and so serves as a model for others.	22 Dissension becomes unity The impure becomes pure The voids shall be filled The old becomes new One who has nothing, receives everything One who has a lot, receives nothing One who is wise cherishes simplicity and in this way he is an example to the world	22. THE GUERDON OF MODESTY The part becometh the whole. The curve becometh straight; the void becometh full; the old becometh new. He who desireth little accomplisheth his Will with ease; who desireth many things becometh distracted. Therefore, the sage concentrateth upon one Will, and it is as a light to	22 To be whole, let yourself break. To be straight, let yourself bend. To be full, let yourself be empty. To be new, let yourself wear out. To have everything, give everything up. The Tao■Master clings to the Tao and becomes a model for all. He doesn't put on a show, but his light shines forth.
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They do not justify themselves and are distinguished. They do not make claims and are therefore given credit. They do not seek glory and therefore are leaders. Because they do not compete, the world cannot compete with them. Is not the ancient saying true, "To yield is to preserve unity?" for true wholeness comes from turning within.	By not showing off, he is exemplary. By not asserting that he is right, he does the right thing. By not boasting of what he will do, he succeeds in doing more than he promises. By not gloating over his successes, his achievements are acclaimed by others. By not competing with others, he achieves without opposition. Therefore the old saying is not idle talk: "Submit to Nature if you would reach your goal." For that is the only genuine way.	He is modest and therefore he excels He doesn't have to prove himself and that's why people trust his words He has nothing to defend and therefore he is invulnerable So the aphorism of the wise of old "The imperfect becomes perfect" is true The perfect considers the world as his home	the whole world. Hiding himself, he shineth; withdrawing himself, he attracteth notice; humbling himself, he is exalted; dissatisfied with himself, he gaineth force to achieve his Will. Because he striveth not, no man may contend against him. That is no idle saw of the men of old; 'The part becometh the whole'; it is the Canon of Perfection.	He doesn't justify himself, but he is known for his integrity. He doesn't boast, but he is recognized as accomplished. He doesn't contend with others, and thus no one contends with him. The old saying, "Surrender and conquer," is not an empty slogan. Surrender to the Tao and find yourself completed.
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23.
Nature
Nature says few words.
A whirlwind does not
last all morning,
nor does a rainstorm
last a whole day.
What causes them?
Nature.
If even Nature's
utterances do not last
long,
how much less should
human beings?
Those who follow the
Way are one with the
Way.

23
Things which act
naturally do not need
to be told how to act.
The wind and rain
begin without being
ordered, and quit
without being
commanded. This is
the way with all natural
beginnings and
endings.
If Nature does not have
to instruct the wind and
the rain, how much
less should man try to
direct them?

23
One who knows
oneself doesn't need a
lot of words
A whirlwind doesn't
last all morning
A shower doesn't last a
whole day
Where do wind and
rain come from?
They sprout from
nature
If nature doesn't endure
its rains and storms
Then why should a
human being have to
talk so much?

23. THE VOID OF
NAUGHT
To keep silence is the
mark of one who is
acting in full
accordance with
his Will. A fierce wind
soon falleth; a
storm-shower doth not
last all
day. Yet Heaven and
Earth cause these; and
if they fail to make
violence
continue, how much
less can man abide in
spasm of passion!
With
him that devoteth him
to Tao, the devotees of
Tao are in accord; so

23
Much talk is contrary
to nature.
The wind doesn't blow
all morning.
The rain doesn't fall all
day.
Wind and rain are
caused by nature,
If nature restrains
herself, shouldn't
people do the same?
He who follows the
Tao is one with the
Tao.

Those who follow
power are one with
power.
Those who abandon it
are one with
abandonment.
Those one with the
Way are welcomed by
the Way.
Those one with power
are welcomed by
power.
Those one with
abandonment are
welcomed by
abandonment.
Those who lack trust
will not be trusted.

Whoever acts naturally
is Nature itself acting.
And whoever acts
unintelligently is
unintelligence in
action.
By acting naturally,
one reaps Nature's
rewards. So by acting
intelligently, one
achieves intelligent
goals. Whereas by
acting unintelligently,
one comes to an
unintelligent end.
Those who do not trust
Nature as a model
cannot be trusted as
guides.

So the One who
follows his conscience,
coincides with his
conscience
One who lives an
exemplary life, will be
an example
One who loses oneself,
doesn't know who he is
anymore
One who finds oneself,
finds bliss
One who loses oneself,
loses true life
One who does not trust
oneself, will not be
trusted

also are the devotees of
Teh, yea, even they
who fail in seeking
those are in
accord.
So
then his brothers in the
Tao are joyful,
attaining it; and his
brothers in the Teh are
joyful, attaining it; and
they who fail in
seeking these are
joyful, partaking of it.
But if he himself
realize not
the Tao with calm of
confidence, then they
also appear lacking in
confidence.

He who is virtuous is
one with Virtue [Te].
He who loses the Tao
becomes a loss.
Surrender to the Tao,
and it will be your
home.
Practice virtue [Te],
and it will be your
abode.
Lose the Tao, and you
will then reside in loss.
No trust given, no trust
received.

24. Avoid Excess Those who stand on tiptoe are not steady. Those who strain their strides cannot long keep up the pace. Those who display themselves do not illuminate. Those who justify themselves are not distinguished.	24 One who tries to stand on tiptoe cannot stand still. One who stretches his legs too far cannot walk. One who advertises himself to much is ignored. One who is too insistent on his own views finds few to agree with him.	24 One who stands on tiptoe, doesn't stand firmly One who walks in a forced way, doesn't come far One who is vain, doesn't shine One who justifies oneself, isn't credible	24. EVIL MANNERS He who standeth a-tiptoe standeth not firm; he who maketh rigid his legs walketh ill. He who preeneth himself shineth not; he who talketh positively is vulgar; he who boastheth is refused acceptance; he who is	24 He who stands on tiptoe does not stand firm. He who walks fast cannot walk far. He who shows off does not shine forth. He who pushes will not succeed.
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Those who make claims are not given credit. Those who seek glory are not leaders. According to the Way these are like extra food and waste, which all creatures detest. Therefore followers of the Way avoid them.	One who claims too much credit does not get even what he deserves. One who is too proud is soon humiliated. These, when judged by the standards of Nature, are condemned as "Extremes of greediness and self-destructive activity." Therefore, one who acts naturally avoids such extremes.	One who brags, will be unmasked One who works one's way up, humiliates oneself To a wise man these are nothing but follies One who lives righteously and honestly, refrains oneself from these things	wise in his own conceit is thought inferior. Such attitudes, to him that hath the view given by understanding the Tao, seem like garbage or like cancer, abhorrent to all. They then who follow the Way do not admit them.	He who boasts will not achieve. He who praises his own work creates nothing that endures. These things inspire disgust. Followers of the Tao spurn them.
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25. The Supreme There is something mysterious and whole which existed before heaven and earth, silent, formless, complete, and never changing. Living eternally everywhere in perfection, it is the mother of all things. I do not know its name; I call it the Way. If forced to define it, I shall call it supreme. Supreme means absolute.	25 There exists something which is prior to all beginnings and endings, Which, unmoved and unmanifest, itself neither begins nor ends. All-pervasive and inexhaustible, it is the perpetual source of everything else, For want of a better name, I call it Nature. If I am forced to describe it, I speak of it as "ultimate reality." Ultimate reality involves initiation of growth, initiation of growth involves completion of growth, and completion of growth involves returning to that whence it came.	25 Before Creation revealed itself There was already something, perfect but formless Quiet and unchanging Ubiquitous and inexhaustible People might consider it as the creating force of everything that is I cannot describe it, but I just call it Tao If I have to interpret it , I would name it “The Universe” With that Universe I mean that which extends itself everywhere	25. IMAGES OF THE MYSTERY Without Limit and Perfect, there is a Becoming, beyond Heaven and Earth. It hath nor motion nor Form; it is alone, it changeth not; it extendeth all ways; it hath no Adversary. It is like the All-Mother. I know not its Name, but I call it the Tao. Moreover, I exert myself, and call it Vastness.	25 Before the birth of Heaven and Earth, there was something without form but complete. Silent. Empty. Independent. Unchanging. Infinite. Eternal. It is the Mother of all things. I cannot classify it, but I call it Tao.
Absolute means extending everywhere. Extending everywhere means returning to itself. Thus the Way is supreme. Heaven is supreme. Earth is supreme. And the person is supreme. There are four supremes in the universe, and the person is one of them. The person reflects the earth. The earth reflects heaven. Heaven reflects the Way. And the Way reflects its own nature.	Nature is ultimate, the principle of initiating is ultimate, and the principle of perfecting is ultimate. And the intelligent person is also ultimate. Four kinds of ultimate, then, exist, and the intelligent man is one of them. Man devotes himself to satisfying his desires, fulfilling his purposes, realizing his ideals, or achieving his goals. But goals are derived from aims. And all aiming is Nature's aiming, and is Nature's way of being itself.	The infinitely extending and returning Therefore the creative is great and the creation great and so is a wise man So there is a trinity of greatnesses and one of them is the true human being A true human being follows his nature, nature and all its eternally unchanging laws The laws of nature are the eternal order of the Universe The order of the Universe is well-founded by the Unnameable	Vastness, the Becoming! Becoming, it flieth afar. Afar, it draweth near. Vast is this Tao; Heaven also is Vast; Earth is vast; and the Holy King is vast also. In the Universe are Four Vastnesses, and of these is the Holy King. Man followeth the formula of Earth; Earth followeth that of Heaven, and Heaven that of the Tao. The formula of the Tao is its own Nature.	Powerful, it creates all things, is present in all things, returns all things to their origin. The Tao is great. Heaven is great. Earth is great. Humanity is great. These are the four great things. Humanity follows Earth. Earth follows Heaven. Heaven follows Tao. Tao follows its own nature.

26. Self-mastery Gravity is the foundation of levity. Serenity masters hastiness. Therefore the wise travel all day without leaving their baggage. In the midst of honor and glory	26 Saneness or sobriety is more basic than frivolity. Calmness or self-sufficiency is superior to being agitated. Therefore the intelligent man, though he goes on a long journey, will never depart far from his means of conveyance. No matter how exciting the distractions, he never submits to their lures.	26 Heavy is the source of that which is light The unmoved mover is the origin of all movement Therefore a true human being can be in motion all day Not because it is him moving himself But because he just floats on life	26. THE NATURE OF MASS Mass is the fulcrum of mobility; stillness is the father of motion. Therefore the sage King, though he travel afar, remaineth near his supplies. Though opportunity tempt him, he remaineth quietly in proper	26 Heavy is the foundation of light. Stillness is the source of movement. Thus, the Taoist Master travels all day without losing sight of the baggage cart. He is not swept away by splendid scenery.
they remain leisurely and calm, How can a leader of a great country behave lightheartedly and frivolously? In frivolity, the foundation is lost. In hasty action, self-mastery is lost.	What would happen if Nature were to act frivolously? If it became frivolous, it would be deprived of its sanity. If it became agitated, it would lose control of itself.	Like a spectator he enjoys the wonderful and sparkling creation Why should he, as the centre of the world, Consider himself minor to that world? One who knows his grandeur, comes loose of the world One who wanders restlessly in that world, has lost oneself	disposition, indifferent. Should the master of an host of chariots bear himself frivolously? If he attack without support, he loseth his base; if he become a raider, he forfeiteth his throne.	He remains quiet and unperturbed. Why should the lord of the land allow himself to be swept away? Allow yourself to be swept away, and you lose your foundation. Allow yourself to be moved, and you lose self-mastery.

27. Using the Light A good traveler leaves no trace. A good speaker makes no slips. A good accountant uses no devices. A good door needs no bolts to remain shut. A good fastener needs no rope to hold its bond. Therefore the wise are good at helping people, and consequently no one is rejected.	27 The wise traveler has no need to retrace his steps. The effective speaker does not need to repeat himself. The generous trader needs no scales. The self-closing door needs no bolt, for it will not open itself even though it is not forced to stay shut. Things which go together naturally do not have to be tied; for they will not separate even without bonds. Therefore the intelligent man expresses his beneficence to other men by accepting each man's own way as best for himself.	27 A true traveller never takes a beaten road A true speaker has an answer to every question A true researcher has solved all problems A story that holds water needs no confirmation Nobody can refute a watertight story One who sees how perfectly everything is connected with everything Needs no theories or opinions, and no one can bring him to doubt That's why a true human being is a teacher of others	27. SKILL IN THE METHOD The experienced traveler concealeth his tracks; the clever speaker giveth no chance to the critic; the skilled mathematician useth no abacus; the ingenious safesmith baffleth the burglar without the use of bolts, and the cunning binder without ropes and knots. So also the sage, skilled in	27 Following the Tao, the Tao■Master leaves no tracks, speaks without error, counts without markers. No locks on his door, and yet no one can open it. No rope used, and yet his knots cannot be untied. Thus, the Tao■Master cares for all beings and neglects none.
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They are good at saving things, and consequently nothing is wasted. This is called using the Light. Therefore the good teach the bad, and the bad are lessons for the good. Those who neither value the teacher nor care for the lesson are greatly deluded, though they may be learned. Such is the essential mystery.	And he performs the same service for all other beings, for he willingly recognizes that, by following its own nature, each thing does the best that can be done for it. This may be called the two-pronged lesson: Bad men can learn from the good man's successes. Good men can learn from the bad man's failures. Whoever despises such teachers, whether good or bad, or who fails to appreciate such lessons, Even though he may be a "walking encyclopedia," is really a misguided fool. This is the secret of wisdom.	And he loves his fellow men unconditionally Therefore he is shepherd of the whole creation And respects every thing that lives and grows People call this: "The light that has become human" Therefore a true human being is a mirror for the untrue And it's his task to point out their imperfections One who is scared to take a look at oneself and does not love oneself Might know a lot of things, but he is blind It seems odd, but it's true	man-emancipation-craft, useth all men; understanding the value of everything, he rejecteth nothing. This is called the Occult Regimen. The adept is then master to the zelator, and the zelator assisteth and honoreth the adept. Yet unless these relations were manifest, even the most intelligent observer might be perplexed as to which was which. This is called the Crown of Mystery.	Thus, he follows the light. The Tao■Master teaches the fool; and thus the fool learns. But teaching and learning will not take place unless the student values the teacher and the teacher loves the student. This is the subtle secret of teaching and learning.
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28.
The Valley of the World
Know the male and keep to the female.
Become the valley of the world.
Being the valley of the world is eternal power and returning to the innocence of a baby.
Know the bright and keep to the obscure.
Become an example for the world.
Being an example for the world is eternal power

28
He who knows how to be aggressive, and yet remains patient, becomes a receptacle for all Nature's lessons. Being thus receptive, he continually reembodies intelligence, and recuperates his primal nature.
He who knows how to be brilliant, and yet remains demure, becomes the ideal which all things have as their ultimate goal. Being thus the ideal, he actualizes the unending goal of existence, and reinstates his primordial condition of perfect self sufficiency.

28
One who knows his strength and yet stays mild, is the least
Whoever is the least, is balanced like the open-minded child he once was
One who has fathomed the lie is an example for the world
One who became human again is an example for the world

28. THE RETURN TO SIMPLICITY
Balance thy male strength with thy female weakness and thou shalt attract all things, as the ocean absorbeth all rivers; for thou shalt formulate the excellence of the Child eternal, simple, and perfect. Knowing the light, remain in the Dark. Manifest not thy Glory, but thine obscurity. Clothed in this Child-excellence eternal, thou hast attained the Return of the First

28
Know the male, maintain the female: become the channel of all things.
Become the channel of all things, and true power [Te] will endure.
You will be reborn.
Know the white, maintain the black: become the form of all things.
Become the form of all things, and true power [Te] will endure.
You will return to the Infinite.

and returning to the infinite.
Know glory and keep to humility.
Become the valley of the world.
Being the valley of the world is eternal power and returning to the natural.
Breaking up the natural makes instruments.
The wise use them and become leaders.
Therefore a leader does not break.

He who know how to be proud, and yet remains humble, becomes the recipient of all Nature's bounties. Being thus receptive, he reintegrates intrinsic goodness, and restores primitive wholeness.
Intrinsic goodness, when devoted to varieties of uses, functions as instrumental value.
When the intelligent man employs instrumental values, he treats them as means to ends, For he is concerned with the ultimate ends, never mistaking the means as ends in themselves.

One knowing oneself, is a knowing among the ignorant
One who has returned to his original purity, realizes his grandeur
One who has abandoned his origin, becomes civilized
To the wise man they are like actors

State. Knowing splendour of Fame, cling to Obloquy and Infamy; then shalt thou remain as in the Valley to which flow all waters, the lodestone to fascinate all men. Yea, they shall hail in thee this Excellence, eternal, simple and perfect, of the Child.
The raw material, wrought into form, produceth vessels. So the sage King formulateth his Wholeness in divers Offices; and his Law is without violence or constraint.

Know honor, maintain humility: become the valley of all things.
Become the valley of all things, and true power [Te] will endure.
You will find the simplicity of nature.
Uncarved wood, when carved by the Tao■Master, becomes a well■governed state.
The best carving is that which is not carved at all.

29. Do Not Tamper with the World Those who take over the world and act upon it, I notice, do not succeed. The world is a sacred vessel, not to be tampered with. Those who tamper with it, spoil it.	29 Whenever someone sets out to remold the world, experience teaches that he is bound to fail. For Nature is already as good as it can be. It cannot be improved upon. He who tries to redesign it, spoils it. He who tries to redirect it, misleads it.	29 One who thinks he is capable of improving Creation, will not succeed Creation is perfect and cannot be corrected One who intervenes in nature, will only destroy nature One who tries to control nature, will lose to nature	29. REFRAINING FROM ACTION He that, desiring a kingdom, exerteth himself to obtain it, will fail. A Kingdom is of the nature of spirit, and yieldeth not to activity. He who graspeth it, destroyeth it; he who gaineth it, loseth it.	29 Do you think you can control the world? I don't think so. The world belongs to the Tao. It can't be controlled. If you mess with it, you'll ruin it. If you try to grab it, you'll lose it.
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Those who seize it, lose it. Some lead, and some follow. Some blow hot, and some blow cold. Some are strong, and some are weak. Some are up, and some are down. Therefore the wise avoid excess, extravagance, and pride.	Consider how Natures operates: Some things precede while others follow. Some things blow one way while some blow another. Some things are strong while others are weak. Some things are going up while others are going down. Therefore the intelligent man avoids both extremes, shunning excess in one way as well as in the other.	Because everything is what it is and everything happens as it happens At times it is warm and then it is cold At times there are storms and then it's calm There is growth and then there is lying down A wise man lets himself flow along with the streams of life	The wheel of nature revolveth constantly; the last becometh first, and the first last; hot things grow cold, and cold things hot; weakness overcometh strength; things gained are lost anon. Hence the wise man avoideth effort, desire and sloth.	Some things move on; others remain behind; some things are hot; others are cold; some things are strong; others are weak; some things are up; others are down. The Tao■Master renounces extremes, excess, and extravagance.
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30. Force of Arms Whoever advises a leader according to the Way opposes conquest by force of arms. The use of force tends to rebound. Where armies march, thorns and brambles grow. Whenever a great army is formed, scarcity and famine follow. The skillful achieve their purposes and stop. They dare not rely on force.	30 Whoever tries to help Nature run itself does not need to use force. For force will be met with force, and wherever force is used fighting and devastation follows. After the battle come years of destitution. He who is wise lets well enough alone. He does not press a victory by further conquest.	30 One who advocates a righteous world, uses no violence Because One who uses violence, provokes violence And where discord rules there is chaos And after times of conflict lean years will follow The righteous one does what he can and forces nothing Is not proud about what he achieves	30. A WARNING AGAINST WAR If a king summon to his aid a Master of the Tao, let Him not advise recourse to arms. Such action certainly bringeth the corresponding reaction. Where armies are, are weeds. Bad harvests follow great hosts. The good general striketh decisively, once and for all. He does not	30 How to govern in accordance with the Tao: No conquest by force of arms. Weapons always turn back against themselves. Encamp an army today; the campground is all thorns and brambles tomorrow. Make war for a month; there will be famine for years.
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They achieve their purposes, but do not glory in them. They achieve their purposes, but do not celebrate them. They achieve their purposes, but do not take pride in them. They achieve their purposes, but without violence. Things reach their prime and then decline. Violence is contrary to the Way. Whatever is contrary to the Way will soon perish.	When peace has been restored, he does not behave like an arrogant victor. When security has been regained, he does not gloat like a conqueror. When he gets what he needs, he does not destroy those who have been defeated. Whenever he does something which he has to do, he does it without cruelty. When things reach maturity, they decay of themselves. So cruelty is unnatural. Whoever acts unnaturally will come to an unnatural finish.	Does not brag about what he achieves Does not boast about what he achieves He only does what he does because that's all he can do And he never uses power or violence Civilizations which have reached their peaks Usher in their decay Civilizations are unnatural And what's unnatural, will perish	risk by overboldness. He striketh, but doth not vaunt his victory. He striketh according to strict law of necessity, not from desire of victory Things become strong and ripe, then age. This is discord with the Tao; and what is not at one with the Tao soon cometh to an end.	Do what needs to be done, but do not rejoice in victory. Make war, if necessary, and win, but without arrogance, without hostility, without pride, without needless violence. War, victory, and the rest do not last. They are contrary to Tao. What is contrary to Tao perishes quickly.
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31. War and Peace Weapons are tools of destruction hated by people. Therefore followers of the Way never use them. In peace leaders favor the creative left. In war they favor the destructive right. Weapons are tools of destruction, not used by good leaders. When their use cannot be avoided,	31 Weapons have a negative value, for they create fear in others. Therefore, the follower of Nature avoids them. For when among intimates, one naturally prefers the gentler, more trusting, position on the left. And when among enemies, one naturally jockeys for the more strategic position on the right. Since weapons have a negative value, the intelligent man will have nothing to do with them if he can. But when he is forced to use them, he does so with reluctance and restraint. He does not admire conquest. For whoever desires to conquer desires to kill. —	31 How ingenious weaponry may seem to be, though it will always be disastrous rubbish Everybody hates it A righteous man saves himself from it While a true man will not soil his hands with it A fighter grabs for it Weapons are not good for meek people They bring nothing but trouble One who is wise will never ever use a weapon Because peace and quietness are more precious to him	31. COMPOSING QUARREL Arms, though they be beautiful, are of ill omen, abominable to all created beings. They who have the Tao love not their use. The place of honour is on the right in wartime; so thinketh the man of distinction. Sharp weapons are ill-omened, unworthy of such a man; he useth them only in necessity. He valueth peace and ease, desireth not violence of victory. To desire victory is to desire the death of men;	31 Weapons generate fear; all creatures hate them. Therefore, the Tao■Master tries not to use them . . . He uses them only when there is no alternative, and then without joy, in a calm and restrained way.
the best policy is calm restraint. Even in victory there is no glory. Those who celebrate victory delight in slaughter. Those who delight in slaughter will not be successful leaders. The killing of many should be mourned with sorrow. A victory should be celebrated with funeral ceremonies.	— — — — — — — — — — — — — — — — — — — —	He doesn't enjoy victory Because one who enjoys victory Enjoys his fellow men getting killed And one who enjoys their fellow men getting killed Will never find peace in oneself Prosperity is considered as a personal merit Misfortune on the other hand is considered as an ironic freak Victory is the merit of men And defeat the blame of the commander But victory and defeat only brings losers	and to desire that is to fail to propitiate the people. At feasts, the left hand is the high seat; at funerals, the right. The second in command of the army leadeth the left wing, the commander-in-chief, the right wing; it is as if the battle were a rite of mourning! He that hath slain most men should weep for them most bitterly; so then the place of the victor is assigned to him with philosophical propriety.	Enjoy weapons, enjoy killing. Enjoy killing, lose yourself . . . The killing of many people should create sorrow and grief. A great victory is a funeral ceremony.

32. The Natural Way The Way is absolute and undefined. Like natural uncarved wood in simplicity, yet none in the world can overcome it. If leaders would hold to it, the whole world would serve them spontaneously. Heaven and earth join, and gentle rain falls,	32 Nature is always indeterminable. Although, in its original simplicity, it may appear to be helpless, no one else can tell it what to do. If legislators and administrators could keep this in mind, everybody would obey their laws without enforcement. When opposites supplement each other, everything is harmonious. Without compulsion, each supports the other.	32 The Unspeakable is eternal and is not to be spoken of in words Just like a rough piece of wood, it's not useful to anyone If leaders were an example of true living Everyone would join his true nature at the same time The heavens would dew and the clouds rain justice And without human intervening	32. THE WISDOM OF THE The All-Tao hath no name. It is That Minute Point yet the whole world dare not contend against him that hath it. Did a lord or king gain it and guard it, all men would obey him of their own accord. Heaven and Earth combining under its spell, shed forth dew, extending	32 The Tao cannot be named or defined. It is invisible, but it contains all things. If rulers could master it, then everything would fall into place. Heaven and Earth would be united. A sweet rain would fall. People would be just without regulation.
beyond the command of anyone, evenly upon all. When civilization arose, names began. With names, one should know when to stop. Knowing when to stop, frees one from danger. The Way in the world is like rivers and streams flowing into the sea.	But when boundaries between opposites appear, then the boundary lines are marked out. Once one begins to differentiate between one thing and another, how will we know where to stop? To know when to stop making distinctions is to be free from error. The true relationship of every determinate thing to Nature is reintegrative, like all the rivers and rivulets ever running to their ocean.	That altogether would benefit every single thing that lives beneath the firmament But when discord is born Everything must have a name Keep in mind that when everything has a name, You'll have to stop all that Because one who stops will bounce off danger Compared to the twisted tributaries of mistake The straight and simple road is like a powerful stream	throughout all things of its own accord, without man's interference. Tao, in its phase of action, hath a name. Then men can comprehend it; when they do this, there is no more risk of wrong or ill-success. As the great rivers and the oceans are to the valley streams, so is the Tao to the whole universe.	However, when people seek to rule, they divide the whole and begin assigning names to things. And now, there are names upon names. Too many! The naming must stop. Knowing when to stop saves us from danger. Tao in the world is like rivers flowing into the sea.

33. Inner Power Those who know others are wise. Those who know themselves are enlightened. Those who overcome others require force. Those who overcome themselves need strength.	33 He who knows much about others may be learned, but he who understands himself is more intelligent. He who controls others may be powerful, but he who has mastered himself is mightier still.	33 One who sees trough the other is clever One knowing oneself is wise One who conquers the other is powerful One conquering oneself is inviolable	33. THE DISCRIMINATION (VIVEKA) OF THE He who understandeth others understandeth Two; but he who understandeth himself understandeth One. He who conquereth others is strong; but he	33 Knowing others is a kind of knowledge; knowing yourself is wisdom. Conquering others requires strength; conquering yourself is true power [Te].
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Those who are content are wealthy. Those who persevere have will power. Those who do not lose their center endure. Those who die but maintain their power live eternally.	He who receives his happiness from others may be rich, but he who whose contentment is self-willed has inexhaustible wealth. He who occupies a place provided for him by others may live a long life, but he who dwells in his own self-contained place, even though he decays, is eternal.	One who is satisfied is rich One that wants a lot is busy all the time One who stays oneself, is a four-square fellow One who dies before dying, lives in the present forever	who conquereth himself is stronger yet. Contentment is riches; and continuous action is Will. He that adapteth himself perfectly to his environment, continueth for long; he who dieth without dying, liveth for ever.	To realize that you have enough is true wealth. Pushing ahead may succeed, but staying put brings endurance. Die without perishing, and find the eternal.
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34. The Great Way The great Way flows everywhere, both left and right. All things derive their life from it, and it does not turn away from them. It accomplishes its work, but does not take possession. It provides for and nourishes everything,	34 Ultimate reality is all-pervasive; it is immanent everywhere. All other things owe their existence to it and draw their sustenance from it, without anyone being refused. Having created and and nurtured them, it does not demand title to them. Even though it has provided for all, it refuses to dominate over a single one.	34 That which makes everything exist, is present everywhere It spreads itself throughout the entire Creation Everything owes its existence to It, everything to its own nature It gives everything for nothing It cherishes and guards everything and everyone, but expects nothing in return	34. THE METHOD OF ATTAINMENT The Tao is immanent; it extendeth to the right hand as to the left. All things derive from it their being; it createth them, and all comply with it. Its work is done, and it proclaimeth it not. It is the ornament of all things, yet it claimeth not fief of them; there is	34 The Tao is like an overflowing river. It rises to the left and to the right. The ten thousand things arise from it, but do not depart from it. The Tao acts, but cannot be defined. It clothes and nourishes all beings, but does not rule over them.
but does not control them. Always without desires, it may be considered small. The destination of all things, yet claiming nothing, it may be considered great. Because it never claims greatness, its greatness is achieved.	Since it asks nothing in return for its services, it may appear as of little worth. But all things return home to it again, even though they do not know that they are being called home. Therefore it may be thought of as ultimate. Since it never claims ultimacy for itself, it is, by that very fact, ultimate indeed.	Because It does not wish for anything, It seems to be important It makes everything appear and disappear again But Itself is eternal Therefore the one who is wise is modest And because he is modest, His actions are grand	nothing so small that it inhabiteth not, and informeth it. All things return without knowledge of the Cause thereof; there is nothing so great that it inhabiteth not, and informeth it. In this manner also may the Sage perform his Works. It is by not thrusting himself forward that he winneth to his success.	It endures without desire and without seeming "big." The ten thousand things find their home in it, and yet it does not exercise lordship over them. The Tao is very great, but it does not show its greatness. Therefore, it is truly great.

35. The Inexhaustible Way Hold to the great form, and all the world follows, following without meeting harm, in health, peace, and happiness.	35 He who grasps the ultimate structure of reality draws everyone to him. They approach him without being harmed, but find security, satisfaction, and contentment. Particular goods of various kinds attract the interests of men as they travel through life.	35 For one who beholds the perfect arrangement of things Everything falls in its rightful place Nothing can harm him, and rest and peace will fall to him	35. THE GOOD WILL OF THE TEH The whole world is drawn to him that hath the likeness of the Tao. Men flock unto him, and suffer no ill, but gain repose, find peace, enjoy all ease.	35
Music and delicacies to eat induce travelers to stay. But the Way is mild to the taste. Looked at, it is invisible. Listened to, it is inaudible. Applied, it is inexhaustible.	But the all-pervasive way of Nature attracts no attention to itself (for its true nature is not found to be in particulars). Even though it is present in the mouth, it remains untasted. Even though it is embedded in all objects, it remains unseen. Even though it permeates sound, it remains unheard. Yet, no matter how much we use it, it can never be exhausted.	Along the way there are travellers who yield music and feasts Because the road to self-knowledge is acrid and unpleasant Not pleasant to face Painful to hear But giving an inexhaustible strength	Sweet sounds and cates lure the traveler from his way. But the Word of the Tao; though it appear harsh and insipid, unworthy to hearken or to behold; hath his use all inexhaustible.	Kapitel nicht vorhanden / chapter not available

36. The Mystic Light In order to contract, it is necessary first to expand. In order to weaken, it is necessary first to strengthen. In order to reduce, it is necessary first to build up.	36 The purpose of contracting (returning to Nature) is served by expanding (emerging out of Nature in the first place). The purpose of weakening (subsiding or satisfying of desire) is served by strengthening (arousing the will to live). The purpose of decline (of individual self-assertion) is served by arising (of individuality).	36 Only what's stretched out can be pulled together Only what's fortified can be weakened Only what's increased can be decreased	36. THE HIDING OF THE LIGHT In order to draw breath, first empty the lungs; to weaken another, first strengthen him; to overthrow another, first exalt him; to despoil	36 To shrink, you must first expand. To weaken, you must first strengthen. To knock down, you must first raise up. To receive, you must first give.
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In order to receive, it is necessary first to give. This is called the mystic Light. The soft and gentle overcome the hard and strong. As fish stay in the deep water, so sharp weapons of the state should not be displayed.	The purpose of taking away (culminating or perfecting life) is served by being given (ie., "the last of life for which the first was made"). This is the most penetrating insight into the way of life. The giving in or finishing always triumphs over the starting out. Just as a fish should not be taken out of water, So a sword should never be taken from its scabbard.	Only one who has, can lose That must be clear Soft overcomes hard Weak overcomes strong Fishes belong in water Weapons have to be destroyed	another, first load him with gifts; this is called the Occult Regimen. The soft conquereth the hard; the weak pulleth down the strong. The fish that leaveth ocean is lost; the method of government must be concealed from the people.	This is the way things are. Soft overcomes hard. Slow overcomes fast. Fish cannot live out of the water. A nation's best weapons should not be displayed.
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37. The Way Never Interferes The Way never interferes, yet through it everything is done. If leaders would follow the Way, the world would be reformed of its own accord.	37 Nature never acts, yet it activates everything. If legislators and administrators would behave likewise, each thing would develop in accordance with its own nature. Just as, when things develop, those which become passionate are restrained by that passionless one which activates them,	37 The Eternal Creating does nothing And yet it does everything If leaders would give in to it The aspect of the world would change of itself	37. THE RIGHT USE OF GOVERNMENT The Tao proceedeth by its own nature, doing nothing; therefore there is no doing which it comprehendeth not. If kings and princes were to govern in this manner, all things would	37 The Tao never acts, yet through it everything gets done. If rulers could reside in the Tao, everything would fall into place all by itself.
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When reformed and desiring to act, let them be restrained by what is simply natural. Undefined simplicity is free of desires. Being free of desires, it is serene; and the world finds peace of its own accord.	So the way to restrain men's passions is by dispassionate restraint. And thus all passions will subside.	But since people have so much to wish for Only I can be an example The example of true simplicity And when the people decide to follow me The whole world will be in peace	operate aright by their own motion. If this transmutation were my object, I should call it Simplicity. Simplicity hath no name nor purpose; silently and at ease all things go well.	Action is restrained by the Tao. Action restrained, no desire. No desire: tranquillity. All things at peace.
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